ISB

BTC

CLASS OF 2023

You didn't make it this far just to make it this far.

Get Started

Foreword

Hello current students and alumni,

It gives us great pleasure to present to you the BTC Handbook that the PGP Class of 2023 has created to help you navigate the world of interviews and secure your target role during placements in ISB (or when job hopping as an alumnus).

Over the past year, the Club has worked tirelessly to gather and distill all of the knowledge, experiences, and insights that we have gained during our time as students and professionals. We understand that the journey to getting the job you desire can be challenging, and we ourselves were helped tremendously by ISB alumni. As such, this handbook is primarily created as a show of gratitude and an effort to pay the help forward.

We hope that this handbook will serve as a valuable resource for you as you embark on your journey towards your careers. We encourage you to read it thoroughly, ask questions, and leverage the knowledge and experiences of your fellow Club members to support your growth and development.

Please feel free to reach out to us should you need any help. We are committed to providing you with the support you need to succeed, and we look forward to seeing you thrive in your future roles.

Sincerely,

Virat Singh
President, Business Technology Club
Indian School of Business



BTC Core, Hyderabad





BTC Core, Mohali





Table of Contents

Foreword **2**
Table of Contents **5**
Learning Resources **8**
Resume Guidelines **10**
Case Competitions & Pre-Interview Cases **12**
Case Resources 12
Pre-Interview Cases 12
Case Competitions 13
Interview Preparation **14**
Design 14
Improvement 16
“Favourite” Product 17
Guesstimates 18
Metrics 21
Prioritisation 23
Market Entry & Go-To-Market 24
Root-Cause Analysis 25
Monetization / Pricing 27
Technical / System Design 29
Behavioural Questions 30
Interview Experiences **31**
Absolute 31
Adani Digital 32
ADP 34
Airtel 35
Atlassian 36
BCG-X 37
BeatO 38
Brane Enterprises 40
BrowserStack 44
Chargebee 47
Cisco 48
Cogoport 49
DevRev 51
EXL 55
Games24x7 56
Head Digital Works 60

HiLabs 62
Hilti Technology Solutions 66
Housing.com 67
Jio 68
Jivox 75
Keka 76
Media.net 77
Microsoft 81
MPS Ltd. 84
Nagarro 85
Navi 87
Nium 88
Nykaa 93
Paytm 95
Razorpay 99
Shipsy 108
Sprinklr 109
Tata Digital 111
TVS Motors 114
Uber 116
Walmart 117
Winzo 119
Zynga 121
Extra Interview Experiences **125**
Accenture 125
Amazon 127
Atlassian 128
Dream11 134
Epifi (fi.money) 140
Flipkart 147
Google 151
GSN Games 153
Meesho 155
Microsoft 158
Myntra 166
OLX 170
Oyo 178
PhonePe 179
Providence 184

Rupeek 186
ShareChat 189
Swiggy 190
Ula 195
VMWare 196
Walmart 198
Zeta 203
Additional Resources **207**
Postface **208**

Learning Resources

BTC Resources

BTC Co'23 Resources Master List - **IMPORTANT**

BTC Co'23 Session Master List

Books

These books are must-reads as they will help you understand the PM interview process.

- *Decode & Conquer*, by Lewis C. Lin
- *Cracking the PM Interview*, by Jackie Bavaro
- *The Product Manager Interview: 164 Actual Questions & Answers*, by Lewis C. Lin

These next list of books are good-to-read, but not essential.

- *Swipe to Unlock*, by Neel Mehta
- *Hooked*, by Nir Eyal
- *Inspired*, by Marty Cagan
- *The Design of Everyday Things*, by Don Norman

YouTube Channels

- Exponent
- StellarPeers
- PMExercises
- PM Diego Granados

Websites

- **Technology**
  - The Ken
  - TechCrunch
  - Wired
  - Harvard Business Review
- **Product**
  - Medium - Product Love
  - Just Another PM
  - Earnest Product Management
  - Intercom

Podcasts

- TechCrunch Daily Disrupts
- The Product Podcast
- Masters of Scale
- Lenny's Podcast

Products to Read Up On

This is a list of popular products per industry / domain. It is recommended to do a full product teardown or case study on *at least one product per industry* before your interview.

Industry	Products
Fintech / Payments	Razorpay, PhonePe, Google Pay, Paytm, WhatsApp Pay
Investments	Groww, Zerodha, Smallcase
Food Delivery	Zomato, Swiggy, Dunzo
Grocery Delivery	Swiggy Instamart, Big Basket, Amazon Fresh, Zepto
Ride Sharing	Uber, Ola
E-Commerce	Amazon, Flipkart, Myntra
Social Media	Instagram, Threads, Facebook, Twitter, Snapchat
SuperApp	WeChat, Paytm
Cloud Computing	Amazon Web Services (AWS), Google Cloud, Microsoft Azure
Over-the-top (OTT)	Netflix, Amazon Prime, Disney+ Hotstar
Messaging / Communication	WhatsApp, Messenger, Telegram, Gmail
Ad-supported Media	YouTube, Spotify, Twitch, Moj
Real-Money Gaming	Dream11, WinZo, Zynga

Resume Guidelines

You will find previous years' resumes on the KMP portal. It is recommended to go through the resumes which were successfully shortlisted for your target companies and also look at resumes which include work from your previous industries.

Customizations

Look at the job description before you apply to any company. Try to customise your resume to fit the specific JD, such as:

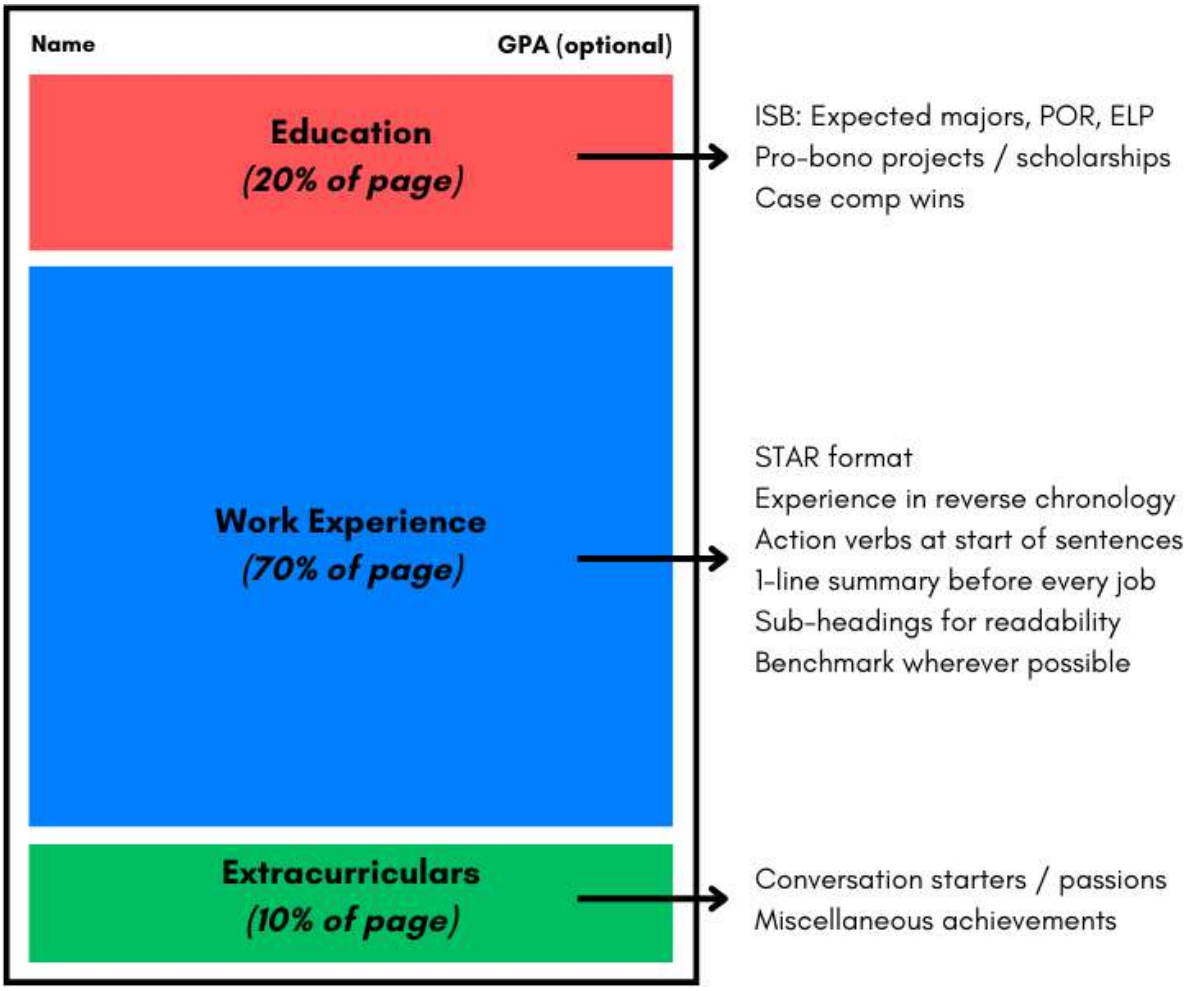
- B2C vs B2B focus
- Tech-focused vs general PM-focused terminology
- Web-apps vs mobile-apps focus

General Guidelines

- In general, "Education" section should be 20% of your resume, "Experience" should be 70%, and "Extracurriculars" should be the remaining 10%
    - "Education" should include ISB (along with your intended majors), your POR, any case comp wins while at ISB, your Masters (if applicable) / Bachelor's degree, ELPs, pro-bono work, and any SIGs you have worked on
    - "Experience" should only include your full-time work experience, internships are not counted
    - "Extracurriculars" should include anything beyond your work or academic settings – this is a great opportunity to connect meaningfully with interviewers, so make it count with activities you're passionate about
- Every point should be in one line; no point should go over one line
- STAR is preferred over RAC. To save line-space, you can just go action-first, result-second
- Any numbers or percentages should be properly benchmarked
  Ex: *"Grew monthly downloads by 10%"* ➜ *"Grew monthly downloads by 10% (20L to 22L)"*
- Use as many product terminologies and metrics as you can
  Ex: *"Reduced time to ship"* ➜ *"Reduced turnaround time"*
- Talk in the language of a PM. Use action words like "prioritised", "shipped", "prototyped", "researched user behaviour", "managed stakeholders", etc
- Don't talk about duties – translate them into wins
- Prepare to be grilled for 30 minutes on every point of your resume in the interview
- Do plenty of alum reviews of your resume.
  Your resume will not be finalised until around 5 - 6 alums have reviewed it
- GPA doesn't matter for product management, feel free to not disclose it if you don't want
- Having a POR is of no value until you mention the impact you have created
- Focus on managerial, technological, product performance, and financial wins primarily

Note: **Here** is a list of action-verbs you can use for your resume.

Anatomy of an ISB Resume:



Case Competitions & Pre-Interview Cases

Case Resources

Past decks
Pre-Interview Cases
Product Case Competitions

Online Resources

1. Flaticon
2. The Noun Project
3. Slides Carnival
4. PowerPoint Templates
5. Balsamiq
6. Canva

Pre-Interview Cases

Case submissions are a critical part of the PM interview process. Around 70% of the PM jobs have a case study round where you would be required to submit a deck (7 - 8 slides) or a document (1500 - 2000 words).

Important things to remember:

1. A large chunk of candidates are filtered during this round so make sure you give your best efforts. No half-hearted submissions
2. Sometimes, your case submission is the first round of interview where you are required to discuss your submission during the interview
3. The biggest and most important aspect of a pre-interview case submission is to really understand the problem statement. Right mix of **primary and secondary research** shows that you have understood the task very well, something that majority of candidates ignore/skip through quickly to designing features and solutions
4. Cracking pre-interview cases requires a balance of creativity and logic. Your submission should have **practical, feasible solutions** which can be implemented by the company. Don't try to build a teleportation device for solving traffic on roads. Try building an ML based predictor which can change the duration of traffic lights based on expected congestion
5. Follow a clear structure. You can take the below mentioned structure as a starting point as make modifications according to the case study-
    a. About the Industry/Company

b. Understanding the Problem
c. User Segments/User Journey
d. Solutions
e. **Metrics** (very important)
f. Implementation plan/GTM

Tips to sail through Pre-Interview Cases:

1. **Make your own template early**: During peak placement days, you will have approximately 1-2 case studies to complete in a single day. This process will become extremely hectic and time taking if you are not prepared beforehand. Having a standardised deck template (some samples are provided in the links above) will help reduce the time it takes to prepare a deck thereby giving you more time to focus on the content of the case study.
2. **Understanding the problem matters:** Your primary goal in any case study should be to understand what problem you're trying to solve. Though it may sound easy and intuitive, it is the most common point of rejection. More often than not, the case study given is something that the company is already working on and wants to evaluate whether you are thinking in the right direction
   Tip: Discuss the case study with alumnus working in the company to get some understanding of the ground reality of the problem. Your solution could be a great one but might not be feasible for the company
3. **Prioritise (important):** You can not do everything. Prioritising which case studies to attempt will play an important role in deciding the outcome. Full effort in 2 case studies would reap better rewards than half hearted effort in 4 case studies. Choosing which case to attempt and which one to leave is the key
4. **Help your friends:** Your friends might be working on an industry/domain case study where you have worked previously. Help them with the insights on the case. Placement battle can't be fought alone. You need allies. Take help and give help always. Your friends getting information from you won't reduce your chances of bagging the best job. Learn and grow together

Case Competitions

Most tips on pre-interview cases also apply to case competitions. Case comps are a good way of understanding different products and industries. Some benefits of doing case comps:

1. **Problem solving and brainstorming skills:** Your interviews won't be focused on what solutions you are giving but rather on how you are thinking about the problem. Case competitions are a good way to sharpen your brainstorming skills.
2. **CV Pointer:** Case competitions are a good CV pointer and are often discussed in the interview.

Interview Preparation

Design

This type of question is most frequently asked in the first and second rounds of interviews and is almost guaranteed to be asked in most product interview processes. The question will be along the lines of designing a particular app or product. Most commonly, these will be digital solutions, but not always.

Example Questions:

- Design a fitness app.
- Design a product to find roommates.
- Design a product to learn finance.

In these questions, following the **CIRCLES** framework is crucial.

C: Comprehend the Situation

Understand exactly what the question is asking of you. This is your chance to ask all the *clarification questions* you need to *narrow down the scope* of the problem as much as you can.
Some sample clarification questions to ask:

- What is the goal of designing this app?
- Do we want to design this for a specific geography?
- Are there time-constraints or resource-constraints while designing?

It might also be good to mention some competitors currently in the market, but only do this if you're running well on time.

I: Identify the Customer

It is crucial to first only focus on a single user cohort. Products are initially designed for narrow user segments. Building a product that is loved by a small segment is better than building a product that is not cared for by anyone. Mention to the interviewer that once we have a foothold on this narrow segment, we can expand to other segments.
Some user segments can be based on either *demographics* (what the users *are*) or *psychographics* (what the users *want*).
Some example user segments:

- **Demographics:** age, generation, profession, income, gender, education-level, etc.
- **Psychographics:** frequency, requirements, goals, price-sensitivity, time-sensitivity, etc.

It is important for the user segments to be **MECE** (mutually exclusive collectively exhaustive).

C: Cut Through, Prioritise

Once you have the list of user segments, you should choose one segment to prioritize. The segment should be based primarily on the goal.

If the goal is user acquisition or engagement, then choosing the largest segment would be advisable. If the goal is instead revenue, then citing the Pareto Principle and segment growth rates are a good reason to choose smaller user segments.
Creating a **user persona** will also be helpful here.

L: List Out Solutions
Once the user persona is created, you should now list down potential pain-points and then solutions to address these pain-points.
Mention a minimum of three and a maximum of five pain-points, then prioritize one of the pain-points. Once this is done, mention a minimum of three and a maximum of five solutions for that one chosen pain-points.
It is important to choose one “hackathon” solution that is easy to build, and one “moonshot” solution that is ambitious in scope.
Be creative: try incorporating generative AI, blockchain, VR/AR, etc. in your solutions if applicable.

E: Evaluate Trade-Offs
Using a classic framework like *RICE* (Reach, Impact, Confidence, Effort) will be helpful for prioritising and evaluating trade-offs.
If you are short on time, do a simple impact-vs-effort matrix instead to evaluate trade-offs, and select that solution which has the highest score (i.e., the highest impact-to-effort ratio).
This selected feature will be the highest prioritised feature. Also mention some key **metrics** that you will use to measure the success of this feature.

S: Summarise:
Do a simple and quick 30-second summary of everything so far.

This should be enough for design questions. Design is the most common interview question type for product roles, so be sure to prepare the framework well.

***Design:* Quick Recap**
Use **CIRCLES**
- **C**omprehend the Situation
- **I**dentify the Customer
- **C**ut Through, Prioritise
- **L**ist out Solutions
- **E**valuate Trade-offs
- **S**ummarise

Improvement

Product improvement questions are very similar to design questions, and most of the process is the same. Follow the CIRCLES method again, but more focus should be placed on the first “C” here.

Example Questions:

- Improve Netflix.
- Improve Google Search for children.
- Improve Swiggy for elderly.

The only difference here is to understand a bit about the company’s strategy, the product’s strengths and its weaknesses in relation to competitors.
The goal with improvement questions is to sharpen and highlight the product’s existing strengths while minimising existing weaknesses.

During the “Comprehend the Situation” bit, you may want to ask the following:

- Why do we want to improve this product?
- Why are we choosing this audience / segment for improvement specifically?
- Will improving this product re-affirm or help another product in the company’s portfolio?

Beyond this, the remaining steps are the same as designing a product. You may be a little constrained because you will need to suggest solutions that are capable of being achieved realistically by that company (for example, you cannot simply suggest Netflix goes into delivery logistics).

If you are not aware about the product mentioned, just mention it at the beginning and try to do a run of a **user journey** so as to understand the product flow well.

Beyond this, the same advice applies for improvement as it does for design.



“Favourite” Product

A “favourite” product question is the same as an improvement question.
This is the *most popular interview question type* so be sure to prepare this well!

It is recommended to have a minimum of **three favourite products**, one of them being a software app or website, the second being a hardware product, and the third being a non-tech product. This is because interviewers sometimes like throwing you off by specifically asking for hardware or non-tech favourite products, to see how you can improve on something with low or no software technological capabilities.

Whatever favourite product you choose, be sure to have answers ready for the following questions:

- Why is it your favourite?
- Why aren’t one of its competitors your favourite?
- Do you have a unique connection with the product that is difficult to replicate?
- What is your most favourite feature of the product?
- How does the product make revenue? What are its avenues of profitability?
    - Is it even profitable for the company in the first place?
- If applicable, how does this product fit in the larger company portfolio?
- What is one thing you dislike the most about this product?

Now, you should speak about how to improve your favourite product. Consider these:

- What does a competitor do better than your chosen product?
- Are there any user segments that are ignored by this product?
- Is the product not profitable enough? Do we want to increase its profitability?
- How can we build a moat around this product to future-proof it?

Once you’ve clarified these, you can select one or two of the above questions to focus on. From here, the interview becomes another improvement interview question.

***“Favourite” Product:* Quick Recap**

- Keep **multiple** favourite products
- Explain **why** the product is your favourite
- Know your product’s **business model**
- How is your product **competitive**?
- Follow up with **CIRCLES**

Guesstimates

Guesstimates are in many ways the quintessential MBA interview question. While they are not as common in product interviews, they can still pop up, and with the right approach, they are a low-hanging fruit in the interview loop. Here's how to approach them.

- **Memorise basic facts**. Here are some (rough) numbers that are helpful to keep in mind.

  Age-wise distribution of population. India is a young country compared to the world.

Ages	India		USA		World	
	Percentage	Raw Numbers	Percentage	Raw Numbers	Percentage	Raw Numbers
0 - 12	20%	280 million	10%	32 million	15%	1.2 billion
13 - 19	20%	280 million	10%	32 million	15%	1.2 billion
20 - 29	20%	350 million	15%	48 million	20%	2 billion
30 - 39	15%	140 million	25%	80 million	15%	1.2 billion
40 - 49	15%	140 million	15%	48 million	15%	1.2 billion
50 - 59	10%	140 million	10%	32 million	10%	0.8 billion
60+	5%	70 million	15%	48 million	10%	0.8 billion
Total	**100%**	**1.4 billion**	**100%**	**320 million**	**100%**	**8 billion**

  Income-based segmentation in India:

Income group (annually)	Population Percent	Raw Numbers
Below-poverty line (< ₹15k)	10%	140 million
Low income (₹15k - ₹1.25L)	51%	714 million
Middle class (₹1.25L - ₹10L)	17%	238 million
Upper middle class (₹10L - ₹30L)	15%	210 million
Rich (> ₹30L)	7%	98 million

  Average annual per-capita income of India: ₹1,72,000
  Average annual per-capita income of the world: $12,000

  Phone/Internet penetration in India: 75% (more in metro/Tier-1 cities than rural areas)

Size of the average image: 1MB
Storage costs: $1 / 50GB (i.e., $0.02 / GB)
Average conversion rate from free-to-subscription for B2B SaaS is 3% (range is 2% - 5%)
Average service subscription fees are $6/month and $60/year
Only 25% of women able to work in India are employed, as opposed to 65% globally

Monthly Active Users (MAUs): *(1 billion = 100 crores)*

Android: 2 billion
Chrome: 2 billion
YouTube: 2 billion (30 million DAUs)
Gmail: 1 billion
Facebook: 2.5 billion
WhatsApp: 2 billion
Instagram: 1 billion
Twitter: 300 million

- **Scope down the problem**. Guesstimate questions are vague in general, so you want to get to the specifics as much as you can to narrow down the problem space.
  For example, if the question is, “Estimate the number of WhatsApp messages sent in ISB”, then some questions you can ask to narrow the scope is:
  - Are messages sent in and to ISB students only counted? What about sent beyond ISB? What about received from beyond ISB?
  - Are group messages counted? If so, should they be counted only once?
  - We are counting messages sent only on the phone? Or also on the web?

  You get the picture.

- **Formulate**. Create a formula to define the problem and be upfront about the way you came up with the formula. Many times, the formula is more important than the raw numbers in an interview setting.
  The formula here can be multiple terms which, when added, multiplied, or divided, can give you the logical number you’re looking for.
  For example, the question is, “Estimate the revenue of Uber.” The formula would be:
  Revenue of Uber = Revenue of Uber rides + Revenue of Uber Eats
  = (# rides * $ / ride) + ($ orders * $ / order)
  = (# rides * $ / ride) + (# orders * [# items / order * $ / item])

- Use **dimensional analysis** to check if your formula is right. “Dimensional analysis” is just a fancy way of saying, “Check your units.” If you are estimating revenue, then the units of the terms in your formula should cancel out to finally give dollar or rupee units. If this is not happening, that’s a sign that your formula is wrong.

- Plug in the **numbers in the formula**. Once you're done with the formula, plug in some actual numbers. These can be based on an educated guess - try to derive whatever number you want based on the above "basic" numbers provided. For example, if smart-phone penetration in India is only 75%, then any number of MAU for a digital app in India cannot be over 75% of the population as an absolute limit.

- **Back-calculate** your answer. This step is crucial to check if you're accurate. An easy way to do this is to use your calculated answer to then calculate the unit economics of the problem. This is much easier to visualise, and if there's any issue with the numbers, it will come out much more easily by checking the unit economics via back-calculation.

***Guesstimates:* Quick Recap**

- Memorize **basic data**
- Narrow down the **scope**
- Create a **formula**
- Keep track of **units**
- **Back-calculate**

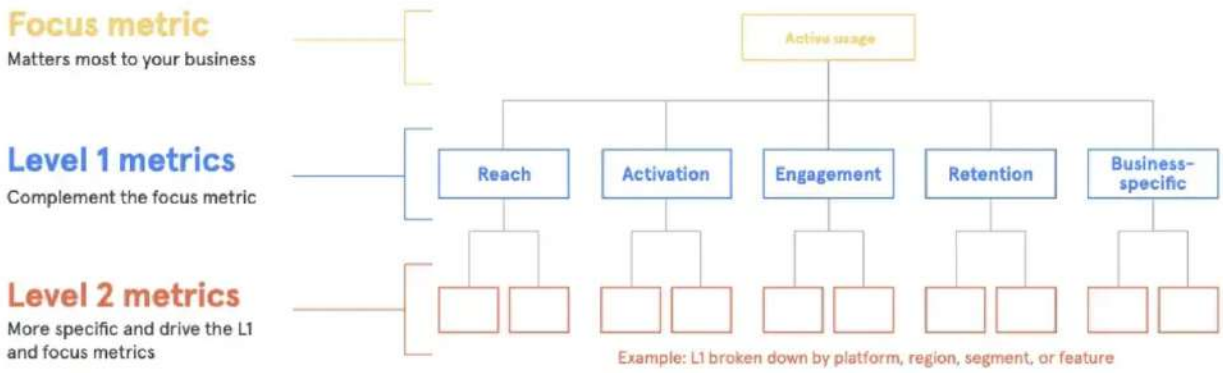
Metrics

Understanding metrics is crucial for the end of design questions, and also to understand how to measure general success of a product.

		Financial Services	SaaS	Retail & Ecommerce	Media
Reach	**Question**	How many people have used the product in a recent time period?			
	Sample metric	Account holders, Signed-in users (3-month window), Subscribers	Users from paid accounts, Active licenses	Active buyers (6-month), Paid subscribers	Paid subscribers, Viewers (3-month window)
Activation	**Question**	What percentage of new users have onboarded and experienced your product's value?			
	Sample metric	% of new users who:			
		Made first deposit within 7 days	Completed registration within 30 days	Completed first purchase	Watched 5 videos in the first 7 days
Active usage	**Question**	Are people showing up regularly and performing a key action?			
	Sample metric	Weekly active users (WAU), Monthly active users (MAU)			
Engagement	**Question**	How engaged are your active users?			
	Sample metric	Transactions, Deposits	Viewed reports, Multi-feature users	Conversions, Recommended product views	Minutes watched, Article reads
		Divided by active users (WAU or MAU)			
Retention	**Question**	How many of your active users come back?			
	Sample metric	7 or 30 day retention			
Business -specific	**Question**	How else does your business deliver value?			
	Sample metric	Savings / Debt ratio of users, Fraud events / User	ARR / DAU, Support tickets / WAU	Average purchase price, Cart abandonment rate	Shares / WAU, Multi-device users / WAU

Understand the above stages of a product's lifecycle (*reach*, *activation*, *engagement*, *retention*, and *monetization* - sometimes called "AARRR") and look at key metrics that determine success. The above table has some examples.

It helps to divide metrics in different "levels": L0, L1, and L2.
L0 should consist of just one metric – ideally your "north-star" metric (also called "focus" metric). This metric should be only related to the main goal. For example, if revenue is your main goal, the north-star could be monthly recurring revenue (MRR) or average revenue per user (ARPU).
L1 should consist of how your prioritised feature relates to the L0 metric. It should be a combination of the feature-specific metrics and the goal-specific metric.
L2 should consist of only feature-specific metrics.
Each of these levels should "feed" into each other. That is, if you increase an L2 metric, logically the corresponding L1 metric should increase, which in turn should increase your chosen L0 metric.



Keep in mind that, in metrics-specific questions, try to “formulate” (break-apart) the metric if you can. It’ll help clear up any confusion later on.

If asked which metric out of two is more important for determining success, try to pin it to the main goal of the business at the time, for example, reach or revenue. Then suggest having an **A/B test**.

***Metrics:* Quick Recap**

- Review popular metrics - **AARRR**
- Level metrics into **tiers**
- Have a **north-star**
- **Break-apart** complex metrics
- Mention **A/B tests**

Prioritisation

As a product manager, you only have so many resources in your disposal. As such, prioritisation becomes crucial at every stage of the interview process. The prioritisation is always done in accordance with the main **goal** chosen in the beginning of the interview.
It is crucial to prioritise at *every stage* of the interview.

User Segments

Prioritise a user segment based on the goal chosen earlier. If reach / acquisition is the goal, prioritise the segment with the largest total addressable market (TAM). If revenue is the goal, prioritising the segment with the largest disposable income makes more sense, even if they are not the largest segment. Similarly, prioritise the user segment based on the goal.

Pain-Points

Prioritise the pain-point again by looking at the main goal. If the goal is regarding user acquisition, prioritise pain-points earlier on in the user journey, such as those regarding signing-up or logging in. If the goal is engagement, then prioritise pain-points that discourage users from utilising certain features, like difficult discovery. These are just examples, but hopefully you understand that the goal needs to be kept at every stage of prioritisation.

Features

To prioritise features, using the **RICE framework** is recommended. If you're running out of time, a simple impact-vs-effort framework can also be used. You will want to prioritise that feature that has the best score, regardless of the framework you choose.
Try to have one "hackathon" solution and one "moonshot" solution.

***Prioritisation:* Quick Recap**

- At the start, prioritise a **main goal**
- Prioritise at **every step** of the interview
  - This includes users, pain-points, features
  - Always prioritise based on the main goal
- For features, use the **RICE** framework

Market Entry & Go-To-Market

These questions are not very common, and are more often a follow-up after a design question. These questions are two-part:

- Should we enter a given market? Is it possible to enter? Is it profitable to enter?
- How can we enter the market optimally?

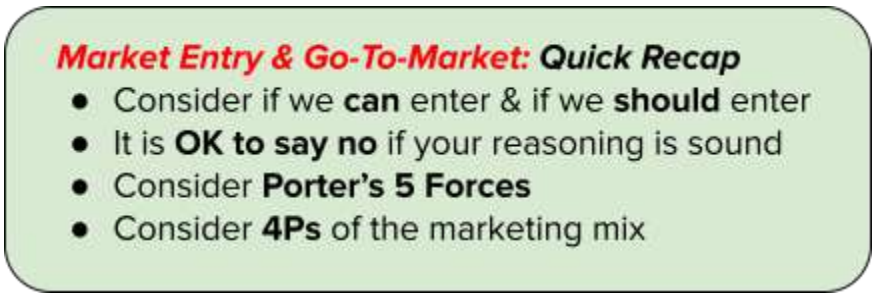
To determine if we should enter a given market, first clarify the goal. Most probably it will only be either user acquisition or profitability.

Check the total addressable market of the given market and its future growth rate. If the market is international, also quickly consider laws or regulations that may prevent entry (for example, the EU has many regulations against large-scale international mergers and acquisitions).
Finally, also look at the *current competition* in the market. Does your product have any unique selling-point or moat that cannot easily be mimicked by the current players?

Utilising **Porter's Five Forces** can also be useful, but the most important aspect of that is the *competition*. Understanding the *threat of substitutes* can also be useful to bring up.
Buying power of consumers is somewhat derived from the competitive landscape, and *bargaining power of suppliers* is generally out-of-scope for product interviews.

Once you have determined that you should enter, now consider how to enter. The **4 P's** of marketing should be helpful here.

- **Product:** Of course, what is the product? If this is a follow-up from a design question, then this will have already been clearly defined. If not, then take some time to understand the product's exact benefits and features.
- **Price:** How expensive is this product? If it's an app, it will likely be free, so how will it be monetized? Understanding the price is a crucial step to determine its adoption rate.
- **Promotion:** How will this product be marketed? We can do either above-the-line, below-the-line, or through-the-line marketing depending on the chosen user segment and the specific product.
- **Place:** Where do the users of the product congregate? For example, if a product is for an older audience, then the place of promotion should be non-digital avenues, or digital avenues used by older demographics, like Facebook.



Root-Cause Analysis

Root-cause analysis (RCA) questions are fairly common in product management interviews, and you are likely to be asked at least one RCA in most product interview loops.

Some examples of these questions:

- The monthly recurring revenue of YouTube fell. Find out why.
- The average session duration on Instagram has fallen. Why?
- The subscription rate of Spotify Premium fell. Why?

These questions are all about having a framework in your approach. The good news: there is a structural method to answering almost all RCA questions. After hearing the question, follow this approach:

1. Definitions & Clarity
2. External Factors
3. Internal Factors
4. Test & Recovery

Let's go through them one-by-one.

Definition & Clarity

Here, we are trying to narrow the scope of the problem as much as possible.

- How do we define this metric? Are there any sub-metrics that lead up to this metric? If you can derive the fallen metric as a formula of other sub-metrics, then the actual problem might be in those sub-metrics.
- Did we notice this change with any particular user group? For example, only with new users, returning users, premium users, free users, etc? Can we divide the groups by demographics, such as by age?
- Did we notice this change in any specific geographies? Such as, only in India or worldwide?
- When did the fall occur? Is it still ongoing? Or was it for a short-burst and recovered? Is it seasonal, i.e., did we notice this fall as part of a pattern?
- Did it happen on both iOS and Android, or desktop if applicable? Which browsers?

External Factors

We now look at potential external factors (the factors that we do not have complete control over).

- Has a competitor released / updated a similar product that is drawing away traffic?
- Is this an overall market trend? Is this happening with our competitors' products as well?
- Is there a news story that broke about our product?
- Is there a change to any upstream / downstream dependency? For example, with sides of the market, payment partners, middle-agents, OS owners, etc.
- Has there been any governmental or societal changes that can affect this? For example, COVID.

Internal Factors

We now look at potential internal factors (the factors that we do have complete control over). Normally, most of the issues occur here. It's still good to talk about external factors first just to show that you're thorough, but if you're running out of time, then you may want to skip to internal factors immediately.

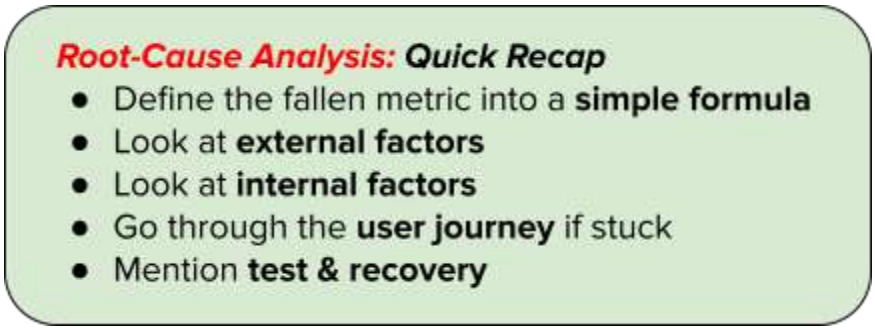
- Did we change the way we are calculating the metric? Is there a problem with the tool that measures it?
- Have we stopped or started any promotions related to the metric?
- Is there an uptick on customer support tickets? If so, what is the commonality in the tickets?
- Did we launch a new feature or update around the time the metric fell? Such as UI/UX changes or core algorithmic changes?
- Have we changed the way users discover / access the feature?
- Is there a change in the way people are opening our app? Maybe through notifications or a boot through another app?

Test & Recovery

Hopefully we have a hypothesis by now about what could be the reason for the metric fall. We should quickly test our theory to make sure we're right. Suggest using an A/B test on a similar control group.

If the test was successful, we know that this is indeed the problem. Now it's time to fix it.

Do not suggest rolling-back the change, as it likely happened for a reason. Instead, try understanding why the change happened in the first place and identify a best-of-both-worlds solution. This can be as simple as changing positions of buttons or as complicated as a refactor of the core algorithm. As long as you can justify your answer, it should be acceptable.



Monetization / Pricing

Pricing and Monetization are critical aspects in product management and are therefore crucial for interview preparation as a lot of companies do ask these directly or indirectly as an extension to product design / improvement cases. The pricing elective can definitely be a plus to help answer a lot of these questions.

Some common questions asked are:

- How would you price a particular product? How do you justify the pricing to the customers?
- How would you increase the revenue of the product?

To answer these questions, there are a few important points to consider, which need to be clarified in the clarifying questions.

- Determine the **business goal**: Generally, if the business goal is to increase the market share, we offer the product at a lower price and if the goal is to maximise profits, we offer a higher price

- **Current market state** and evolution:
    - Growing Market: Can use value-based or perception pricing, as the customers haven't formed an opinion about this
    - Mature Market: Pricing would depend on the business goal as mentioned above
    - Declining Markets: The pricing decision would depend on the business goal - to renew/pivot or exit the market

- **Differentiation:**
    - Product Differentiation: Highly differentiated products can justify higher prices
    - Cost Differentiation: If the company has a cost advantage over competitors, then it can justify lower prices

- **Target Segments:** While pricing the product, we must consider our target markets as well. Understand the segment's willingness-to-pay (WTP) for the product.
    - If we price it above their WTP, they won't even buy it
    - If we price it below their WTP, we are leaving consumer surplus on the table

- **Pricing Models:** After evaluating the above points, one can go with one of the below models to price the product.
  Cost Plus:
    1. Find the total fixed costs and variable costs per unit
    2. Set a markup above this, assuming you can sell X number of units at this price (must do market research and price elasticity for this)
    3. This will be your price

4. Use this to determine the breakeven quantity (optional step, more commonly used in GTM rather than pure pricing problems)
5. Optional: Factor in customer acquisition costs, which will help set a baseline for the costs if asked to price the referral program of a product
6. In certain situations, to double check your calculations, a “golden ratio” for pricing is that the ratio of customer acquisition cost to life-time value should be 1:3. Use this to check if you’re overpricing or underpricing the product.

Value Based (Most commonly used):

1. Find the total value we are generating for a customer – Can be how much they’re saving (if it isn’t monetary savings, try converting to it, for example, if a customer saves a few hours, try to calculate the time value of that money)
2. Charge them something around this, based on business goals and pricing strategy decided above
    a. WTP - Monthly income
    b. Savings of customer

Competitor Based: Charge them somewhere close to what the competitor is charging, based on goals and pricing strategy, whether we want to go offensive or defensive.



Technical / System Design

Technical or System Design questions are generally asked only if you have previous experience of working in the technical role or have mentioned something specific in your resume. Nonetheless, some tech-focused companies may give importance to these questions and expect the candidates to have a basic idea about the technical aspects of the product. You can keep in touch with the technical acumen through basic readings mentioned in the previous sections. Some basics technical questions that can be asked (non-exhaustive):

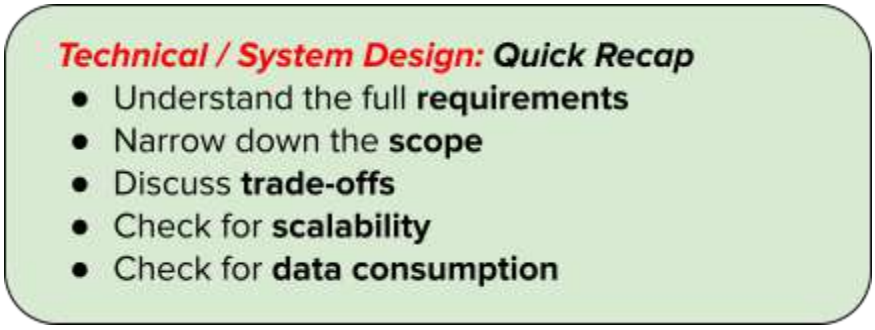
- What is an API? How does it work?
- Explain “some technical term” to a 5 year old. The goal here is to simplify the terminologies as much as possible and explain using an analogy.
- Basic SQL queries (Not very common but does not hurt to be prepared)
- Basic algorithms and pseudo codes (especially for projects mentioned in your resume)
    - For example, “Discuss an algorithm you’d build to recommend YouTube videos.”

System design questions typically involve breaking down a complex problem into smaller, more manageable components and designing a solution that meets user needs while also considering technical feasibility and scalability. You should know how distributed systems work — how each component processes information, communicates, and scales up or down — because this high-level view is critical to strategic decision-making.

To answer system design questions, you can follow the follow steps:

- Clarify the requirements
- Break down the problem
- Discuss trade-offs
- Consider scalability

Communicate the thought process clearly and in a structured format. This will help the interviewers understand your approach to problem-solving and evaluate your ability to work collaboratively with other stakeholders, such as developers and designers.



Behavioural Questions

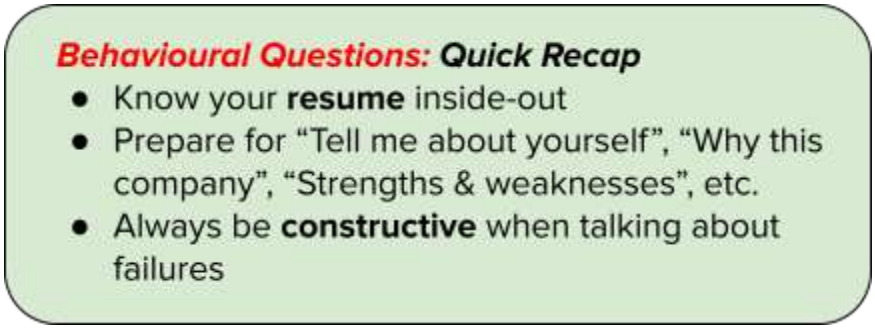
Your success as a product manager hinges on your ability to work well with others. Because product management is an extremely cross-functional role, you can bet interviewers will assess your attitude, behaviour, and thought processes just as thoroughly as your product design, strategic thinking, and analytical skill.

There are a set of questions that one needs to be prepared to answer in any and all interviews. These are no different than the ones you prepared for college admissions but the answers now have to have a lot more reference to your job experience and need to portray your unique self.

Some common questions to prepare for:

- Tell me about yourself.
- Tell me about your most recent job experience/ most exciting project in your company?
- Tell me about a time when you faced a conflict with your teammates and how did you resolve it?
- Tell me about a time when you faced a challenge at work.
- Tell me about a time when you managed multiple stakeholders.
- What has been your biggest mistake and what did you learn from it?
- Why do you want to join this company?
- Tell me 3 strengths and 3 weaknesses.

Prepare answers to these questions in a way that shows some of your strengths as a Product Manager and demonstrates leadership traits.



Interview Experiences

Absolute

Company: Absolute

Senior Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Why my startup failed, Important skills for a product manager.
Answer 1	Standard answers. I was prepared. Made sure to mention stakeholder management as well as customer empathy as the major ones, and also brief expertise in IT management.

Round 2 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Agri-tech supply chain related questions ; SQL query
Answer 1	I knew about agri-trade. So I was comfortable answering the first question. For SQL I told, I can't write the query but I can Google and find. He was happy with the answer.

Adani Digital

Company: Adani Digital

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Describe your startup
Answer 1	Described my role and what it did and story
Question 2	your role as a pm in it
Answer 2	product design and strategy
Advice	Be well versed with your role and collate to the role you're applying to

Round 2 - Behavioural, Product Strategy, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	how did you decide your startup's product roadmap
Answer 1	customer interviews, scrum methodology
Question 2	How would you improve ola
Answer 2	for drivers and users. reduce cancellations by sharing drop location. for users if they cancel have a cancelation fee
Advice	Be well versed with product improvement cases

Round 3 - HR Round [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Nothing specific. Company culture and fit
Answer 1	Describe your values, be yourself. Got till here, o you're in
Advice	Be yourself. Keep it human, candid and build a rapport

Company: Adani Digital

Associate Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural, Guesstimate, Product Strategy, Metrics, Root Cause Analysis [30-60 min]	
Question 1	How many umbrellas are sold in India
Answer 1	Clarified some basic questions such as what kind of umbrellas are we talking about here. Is it only for rain, or protection from sun and decoration purpose umbrellas as well. Then made a tree starting from population of india -- proportion living near coastal areas, mountains and plains -- population is divided into urban and rural for all the demographics -- then calculate per month and yearly number of umbrellas bought in all the categories
Question 2	What are the pain points of booking an Uber? What is the first thing you do after you land at an airport?
Answer 2	Book a cab unless we have our own driver. Pain points: difficulty in choosing destination from the multiple destinations recommended, Uber drivers cancelling the ride. Solution: Similar startup is there in Delhi which does not allow the drivers to cancel the ride. Hence this feature can be added. Or show the destination to the driver beforehand. Through this transparency, the drivers would only accept the ride they are interested in.
Question 3	Tell me something that is not in your resume?
Answer 3	Answered my sports and fashion journey in college.

Round 2 - Metrics [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Questions on Adani digital Labs, the arm they were interviewing for. What is Agile, sprint, ceremonies in Agile
Answer 1	Everything is available on google, and was prepared. These are for the program manager role

ADP

Company: ADP

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
2 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural, Product Strategy, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Youtube Vs Netflix, Analyze Business Model, Long term sustainability
Answer 1	Youtube has a better and more sustainable business model since content is also sourced from users, it is more accessible and has a wider variety of content
Question 2	What did you do in your last role
Question 3	Favourite Product & Improvements
Advice	Build an understanding of the business models of all common products and platforms.

Round 2 - Behavioural, Situational, Product Strategy [0-30 min]	
Question 1	What was your most challenging project and what did you gain from it.
Answer 1	Answered as prepared
Question 2	Future of HR tech
Answer 2	I had a background in HR tech hence the industry specific question

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Airtel

Company: Airtel

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
1 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural, Product Strategy [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Tell me about yourself briefly?
Answer 1	I covered my experience with a focus on product management-related projects/activities (across tech, marketing, and consulting) I have done in the past. The interviewer discussed a couple of stellar projects I mentioned. I also told him how I have worked and my experience with Airtel B2B vendors.
Question 2	Since you have experience across different verticals, before I start the interview, tell me which PM you want to be in Airtel.
Answer 2	I clarified to the interviewer that I'm interested in the General PM role unlike technical and growth PMs. I gave my reasoning why I want to do this.
Question 3	We are in 2050, and the concept of the driverless car has reached perfection in this world. What future problems for Uber will be and how to improve it.
Answer 3	I started with scoping questions and limited my approach to only driverless concepts (not any other tech like AR/VR, Metaverse, etc.). Customer segmentation was straightforward. I decided to target the demand side along with the reasoning. I drew the current user journey and explained my understanding of the cab service. Now, at each touchpoint, I decided to make pain points. Pain point identification was made or broken. The interviewer gave me a couple of examples of pain points and helped me predict pain points accordingly. The basis that I suggested 15+ pain points along with process, tech and user experience. Along with pain points, I also suggested some suggestions or improvements. We also discussed metrics briefly. The interviewer was happy with the customer-oriented approach and later asked me if I had any questions for him. I asked questions related to PM resource allotment in Airtel and other stakeholders to work with within Airtel.
Advice	Airtel typically has only one round (post CV shortlisting) on day 0, which is made or broken. Try to keep this interview as earliest as possible so that you are done with at least one interview of the day.

Atlassian

Company: Atlassian

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - No
3 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Go To Market, Product Strategy [>90 min]	
Question 1	Case Submission : Metaverse solution for office-management collaboration
Answer 1	Detailed word doc - with data, secondary & primary research. Focus on content over presentation as they don't care.

Round 2 - Behavioural, Situational, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Questions Regarding Case submission - basically explain this feature, if you have to pick one feature, one metric what will it be?
Answer 1	Answered as per case
Question 2	What is your Favourite Product? Improvements? How will these improvements move the metrics (by what scale)
Answer 2	Had chosen and prepared for One-Note. Was able to answer most questions - there were multiple regarding notions as well. However improvement % in metrics was something I took a calculated guess which probably didn't land well

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BCG-X

Company: BCG-X

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Go To Market [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Design a product for ICICI Bank which caters to the NRI audience
Answer 1	BCGx follows a standard structure which they themselves discussed during the BCG dinner. Buddy mocks and following the structure was the key to all rounds of BCG

Round 2 - Go To Market [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Design a digital platform/offering for a stationary company like Classmate
Answer 1	BCGx follows a standard structure which they themselves discussed during the BCG dinner. Buddy mocks and following the structure was the key to all rounds of BCG

Round 3 - Go To Market [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Design a solution to cater to home rental needs for the youth in Delhi and Mumbai
Answer 1	BCGx follows a standard structure which they themselves discussed during the BCG dinner. Buddy mocks and following the structure was the key to all rounds of BCG

BeatO

Company: BeatO

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
2 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Situational, Guesstimate, Favourite Product [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Basic discussion on my favourite product.
Answer 1	I described Reddit as my favourite product. The interviewer didn't know much about it and didn't dive deep.
Question 2	How would you apply your learning from ISB in your previous work experience as an engineer? Describe using one situation.
Answer 2	I had a very technical background, and the interviewer being a former techie asked me to not shy away from being technical, so I picked a situation where I came up with a very major coding efficiency related project at work, and found it difficult to convince the management about what impact it would have because I lacked the perspective of explaining its impact on business. The interviewer seemed satisfied with the answer.
Question 3	Guesstimate the number of steps you took yesterday. Do not go deep into numbers, only tell how you would go about estimating it.
Answer 3	Don't remember exactly but i think i gave a formula based on two primary parameters: Time spent walking/standing/running, average steps per minute of each activity
Advice	The interviewers were CTO and VP-Product. I had a feeling that my profile already fit well in the interviewers mind, and they were just doing a sanity check in the interview instead of grilling me on technical stuff. So keep your cool in this round and avoid making mistakes that can weaken your case.

Round 2 - Behavioural, Problem Solving [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Puzzle: How many points are there on the earth where you could travel one mile south, then one mile east, then one mile north and end up in the same spot you started?

Answer 1	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OOzzncDp2oE - I was able to solve partially
Question 2	A bunch of behavioural questions around my strengths and weaknesses, how my study group would describe me, 3 good and bad things they would say about me, did we have conflicts/fights within the study group, etc. Also asked how folks at google who I worked with would describe me as a person. Asked some things about my previous company, Qualcomm, as well since BeatO worked with Qualcomm in the past for developing their product.
Answer 2	My personal answers, I was careful not to reveal anything controversial that they can grill me on. Smiled the entire time and remained full of energy. They even asked how I am full of energy even after so many interviews.
Question 3	Why do I want to join BeatO?
Answer 3	I told them that I want to work in a startup after working in a big organisation before. I also told them that I believed in the problems they are solving for people and want to be part of it.
Advice	This round was taken by the CEO and COO and was very conversational, they were extremely friendly and interactive. They offered me the job at the end of the interview itself.

Brane Enterprises

Company: Brane Enterprises

Solution Leader SaaS

Program Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural, Metrics, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Very conversational interview. The interviewer shared her experience with the firm, explained about its product & how it works. Then the interviewer asked about my professional journey & work experience.
Answer 1	I worked as a Tech Consultant prior to ISB. So, I could clearly understand & relate to the company's product. While narrating my work experience, I tried to highlight the similar aspects of my work to what they were doing and tied them together. This showed that I will be a natural fit for the company & the role. The interviewer was greatly satisfied with my response.
Question 2	Design a solution for students who are looking to apply to universities post their high school education. Who would be the stakeholders involved in the entire ecosystem? What metrics would you track to measure the success?
Answer 2	Important Note: This design question is not the usual product design question. The design needs to be prepared keeping Brane's solution in mind (That's why it's crucial to fully understand their solution from the interviewer). So any product design frameworks are not required. Asked relevant clarifying questions. Stakeholders involved: Students, Parents, Coaching institutes, University committees (Exam, Admission), Test centres, Educational experts, Mock test providers, Banks, Background verification agents etc. Design Flow: 1. Find coaching institutes in New Delhi for JEE Mains. 2. Get the fees and course structure for each coaching institute. 3. Rank the coaching institutes based on specific criterias. 4. Contact the coaching institute. 5. Take the coaching institute entrance exam. 6. Check the entrance exam results. 7. Pay the fees, submit the required documents and join the coaching institute. 8. Find out the best online mock series for JEE Mains. 9. Pay for the mock series and take mocks. 10. Fill JEE Mains exam form and pay exam fees. 11. Receive Admit card. 12. Travel to the exam centre and take the exam.

	13. Get the exam result. 14. Identify colleges according to the result. 15. Rank colleges according to student's preference. 16. Go for admission counselling. 17. Finalise the college & the department. 18. Fill out the selected college admission form & pay the admission fees. Metrics: Due to the shortage of time, the interviewer skipped the metrics part. By this time, the interviewer was already impressed.
Question 3	Your solution is very comprehensive. However, I think your solution focuses more on the coaching institutes rather than the students themselves. What tweaks would you make in your solution?
Answer 3	I would include the following steps in my design flow to make the solution more student-centric: 1. Find nearby study groups for JEE Mains preparation. 2. Find out the best books for JEE Mains preparation. 3. Buy books from Amazon. 4. Prepare a daily timetable for preparation. By this time the interviewer was satisfied and mentioned that I understood their solution perfectly.

Round 2 - Behavioural, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Questions around prior work experience picked up from resume
Answer 1	Answered in detail
Question 2	You need to design an app for football enthusiasts to help them discover like-minded enthusiasts nearby. What are the top 5 features that you would build? (I mentioned in my intro that I play football & follow it closely)
Answer 2	The interviewer was only interested in the features. So, I didn't go through the entire product design framework. Asked a couple of clarifying questions & jumped directly to the features: 1. Profile page to show photos, friends, expertise level, football teams followed etc. 2. Feed with football-only content from national teams, clubs, competitions, journalists, experts, players, fan pages & so on. 3. Nearby football field to locate football fields nearby. 4. Book football field 5. Create a channel/chat to make groups & discuss topics.
Question 3	How would you prioritise among these features and why?
Answer 3	Prioritised based on the criticality & availability of these features through other

	channels.

Round 3 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	This round was taken by a senior advisor to the company. It was again very conversational. The interviewer was trying to gauge my fit to the company. He detailed to me the work culture at the firm. He then asked me a couple of questions regarding my motivation to join Brane, why I would be a good fit for the role, would I be willing to learn the latest technologies & so on.
Answer 1	Answered every point with clarity & confidence.

Company: Brane Enterprises

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
1 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Situational, Go To Market, Product Strategy, Metrics, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	How will you design a product to improve performance of a casual Badminton player
Answer 1	gave 2 product ideas one is to develop apps using existing wearables such as apple watch and monitor sensor data to predict and suggest moves. Second is to design a product with special sensors and give live suggestions through Bluetooth.

BrowserStack

Company: BrowserStack

Associate Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - No
2 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Metrics [0-30 min]	
Question 1	The interview was majorly around the case submitted and the features suggested and metrics used to measure.
Answer 1	I presented my entire case submission with some additional information around competition and some new features which I gathered post the case submission.
Advice	Be thorough on your case submission and get it reviewed from alums if possible to understand any loopholes and address them during the interviews

Company: BrowserStack

Associate Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Case Discussion [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Problem Identification
Answer 1	Explained what all problems I identified and which ones I chose to solve and why?
Question 2	Cross-questioning on problem identification to check product knowledge. Spent a major chunk of time on it.
Answer 2	Made sure to share my understanding of the product w.r.t. the case-study
Advice	Have an in-depth understanding of BrowserStack products and how they actually work in the backend. Spend time on understanding the problem statement.

Round 2 - Metrics, Product Design, Behavioural [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Choose an application of your choice and suggest improvements along with metrics that you would use to measure success.
Answer 1	Chose Instagram; Suggested auto-caption and auto-filter recommending features for a user while posting a picture. Focused on increasing engagement (because Instagram is a mature product) by making it easy for users to post pictures and build their profile. Metrics chosen were feature specific like feature adoption rate and usage frequency. It's important to highlight the entire user journey from the time the user opens the app till he/she posts a picture.
Advice	Product design and product improvement cases should be practised.

Round 3 - Root Cause Analysis [0-30 min]

Question 1	Your favourite product and why?
Answer 1	I chose WhatsApp : I had pre-prepared this question based on the OBUS framework.
Question 2	Suppose DAU for WhatsApp is decreasing. If you were a PM, how would you approach a RCA around this?
Answer 2	Performed a step-by-step analysis . There was no right answer. The interviewer basically wanted to see my approach and if I was able to think in the right direction.
Advice	Don't shy away from asking questions while doing RCA but remember to ask the right questions.

Chargebee

Company: Chargebee

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural, Product Strategy [0-30 min]	
Question 1	I was asked to explain what options can Chargebee explore with regards to subscription management services for OTTs. I was asked questions based on the case submission.
Answer 1	I answered based on my understanding from the pitfalls in current OTT segment payments.
Advice	Just be thorough about what is asked in the case. It's okay even if the entire ppt is not ready if the case is given on a short notice. I ended up doing my research and understanding the problem beforehand but was only able to give solutions in the actual interview.

Round 2 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Why product management
Answer 1	I told my reasons were to move from QA to PM due to my customer empathy, wanting to know the why of features etc.
Question 2	Why mba
Question 3	What do I look for in a company
Advice	Just be yourself. Cultural fit is about knowing if you will fit in the company or not. Do a bit of research about the company and tailor your answers accordingly.

Cisco

Company: Cisco

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Guesstimate [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Revenue of Gmail
Answer 1	Estimate by starting from number of email opened in a day
Question 2	Difficult Situation at work
Question 3	How would you do things differently
Advice	Look at Product Design, Guesstimates, Behavioural

Round 2 - Behavioural [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Explain something from your resume
Answer 1	Picked an impactful work and explained extensively
Advice	Prepare 2-3 structured talking points in your resume

Round 3 - HR Round [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Why Cisco
Answer 1	Already worked at Microsoft, culture fit
Question 2	Competitors of Cisco
Answer 2	Juniper Networks, VMWare, Huawei
Advice	Look up basic company info

Cogoport

Company: Cogoport

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	They asked me about a Big Data project on my Resume
Answer 1	I began by explaining why this project was initiated first. Then I explained the project flow and was asked by the interviewers why some tools were used instead of others.
Question 2	I was asked behavioural questions about why PM, why MBA to become PM, and why ISB.
Advice	Focus on your resume thoroughly. Also, be prepared for a surprising case right before the Interview.

Round 2 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	HR Questions. Why would you choose a startup and not some famous MNCs? I have worked in MNCs in the past, and I was asked if the cultural differences would be there and how you would get accustomed to them.
Answer 1	Answered by mentioning my interest to work in startups and also mentioned I am quickly adaptable

Company: Cogoport

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
2 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Product Strategy, Case Discussion [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Discussion on the business problem that was given prior to the pre assessment round
Answer 1	Discussed how Cogoport can have multiple product offerings for SMEs - only freight forwarding for new customers and end to end solution of freight forwarding + finding traders for export for more trusting customers
Question 2	Why is India a good starting point?
Answer 2	Logistics in India is still growing, middlemen (transporters and brokers) cause information asymmetry, which leads to value loss in the supply chain.
Advice	Be thorough with the case that the company had given to solve (even though it said it was a non eliminative round)

Round 2 - Behavioural, Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	What is product management and why do you fit in this role?
Answer 1	Standard definition. Further added that my experience with data analytics coupled with business acumen acquired during the PGP course puts me at a good footing for this role.
Question 2	Are you actively pursuing activities mentioned in the extracurricular section?
Answer 2	Yes. Mentioned about the SV wars basketball matches and ISB Toastmasters.
Question 3	Are you single/married? Do you think monogamists are compliant people and hence not adventurous?
Answer 3	(taken slightly aback) Answered by saying that being adventurous doesn't simply mean being non compliant. Embracing the risk in the face of the unknown is what begins to define adventure.
Advice	Keep you calm and be thorough with your resume.

DevRev

Company: DevRev

Strategic Business Operations

General Management
Job Offered - Yes
4 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural, Situational [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Resume grilling.
Answer 1	The interviewer was super interested in my previous experience at Flipkart and he went into the minutest details for 45 minutes. Be very thorough with your resume
Question 2	Why DevRev? Why startups?
Advice	Be very thorough with your resume

Round 2 - Behavioural, Go To Market [30-60 min]	
Question 1	How would you launch DevRev in Japan
Answer 1	Followed the GTM framework from the handbook. Market opportunity, viability(financial and operational), STP 4P
Question 2	Why DevRev?

Round 3 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Culture-fit round. Was quite chill
Answer 1	Just be honest about yourself, it was straight forward.

Company: DevRev

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Product Design, Case Discussion [30-60 min]	
Question 1	We were asked to present a deck on improving your favourite product. Had to answer follow-up questions. I presented deck on Dunzo
Answer 1	Answered how can Dunzo improve their delivery time by forecasting the demand

Round 2 - Behavioural [30-60 min]	
Question 1	What has been your journey till now
Answer 1	Gave a 20 min walkthrough of my career and interest. Interviewer was more interested in knowing me as a person
Question 2	Why Devrev?
Answer 2	I really see problems with JIRA right now and think that Deverev will fix them all. Plus I want to join a startup that is early stage and has small team

Round 3 - CEO Round [30-60 min]	
Question 1	In this round, I had to ask all the questions I had about Devrev to the founder
Answer 1	I asked - What does Devrev actually do? What is the product road map of Devrev? In which stage are we in the product road map?

Company: DevRev

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural, Situational, Go To Market, Product Strategy, Metrics, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	To explain the case submission done in pre-assessment round. We were told to submit a deck on any of our most personally used products and suggest enhancements in it by doing customer research, building user personas, wireframes, solutioning and metrics
Answer 1	Just covered every aspect of the case deck I had submitted on my heavily used product GoodReads in details and there were a lot of follow up questions on product strategy , design and possible streams of monetization
Question 2	A lot of behavioural questions centred around why will I be a good fit for startups and how startups will be a good fit for me
Answer 2	I talked about a past internship stint at a startup and what are my expectations of working in a startup and what are the potential downsides and how I plan to handle those
Advice	Be very thorough with the analysis of pre-assessment round case deck and pay attention to UX and design of the wireframes as well because they asked a lot of questions around why users would find a certain design or UX better than another alternative

Round 2 - Behavioural, Situational, Product Design [0-30 min]	
Question 1	A lot of behavioural questions were asked by giving situations and also questions were asked regarding my previous work experience about conflicts faced
Answer 1	Answered all this in brief and concise points and gave them enough context about my previous work experience to make the answers more comprehensible for them
Question 2	Product design question on improving any of the top 3 Google products I use
Answer 2	I chose Gmail and started with a specific goal for improvement and then built on it with users personas and key challenges faced followed by solutions

Round 3 - Go To Market [0-30 min]	
Question 1	How would I launch Devrev's Product in a different geography like Japan?
Answer 1	This was an unconventional question, so thought of all the sequence of steps needed to expand a product into a market and then thought of a lot of subjective requirements that would be very specific to Japan as well and added those to the list of actions
Question 2	Some behavioural questions around why I wanted to shift to PM from a past developer role as the interviewer was also from a software engineering background
Answer 2	Answered honestly about why I had planned for the transition and what skills I possessed to make the transition smooth and what are the new skills I had to build upon
Advice	Being confident and thinking on the feet spontaneously is needed

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EXL

Company: EXL

Program Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
2 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural, Situational, Go To Market, Product Strategy [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Guesstimate about number of users on instagram
Answer 1	Started with population and cell phone penetration, then major target segment

Round 2 - Product Strategy [30-60 min]	
Question 1	How to make people on Facebook move to instagram as well
Answer 1	Discussion about basic diversification tactics

Games24x7

Company: Games24x7

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural, Product Strategy, Metrics, Root Cause Analysis, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	What is your favourite product?
Answer 1	Zerodha (picked my strength since I was from a finance background)
Question 2	If you were to destroy Zerodha, how would you do it?
Answer 2	Use CIRCLES framework and modify it. Understand what users we are talking about. Zerodha has long term investors and traders/ F&O investors. Interviewer asked me to pick one - picked long term investors (again because I understood this better). Break down user journey from registration to buying stocks to dashboard to sale and receipt of money. Point out what is good about each stage and destroy that by doing the opposite.
Question 3	RCA - Swiggy restaurant sales are going down.
Answer 3	I used the RCA framework from the BTC handbook. Ask all the questions to find a root cause. I could not actually reach the root cause considering lack of time. But probably did okay in terms of asking questions (blindly followed the RCA framework from BTC handbook)
Advice	Prepare for RCA, Favourite product - standard PM prep. Don't worry if they ask an unusual question - they're just looking for quick thinking. It's okay if you don't use a framework.

Round 2 - Behavioural, Situational, Product Strategy, Product Design [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Behavioural - Why PM? Why after finance?
Answer 1	Wanted to understand the motivation to become PM. As a CA, why do I want to enter PM/ Tech.

	Spoke honestly. Gave my reasons. Nothing specific
Question 2	What features would you introduce to Netflix?
Answer 2	Understood the problem - wanted to add features to replicate the feeling of cinema at home. Broke down what about cinema can you replicate at home - social angle, feeling of collective watching movie. Suggested 3-4 features like Netflix party, simultaneous video and audio streaming (video call), feature to remove background noise, etc.
Advice	Nothing specific, just be honest and genuine - they can see through lies

Company: Games24x7

Product Manager 2

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
4 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Go To Market, Go To Market [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Pre-Assessment Case : Feasibility analysis of second-hand marketplace with charity proceeds
Answer 1	Slides with feasibility analysis (primary, secondary data, sustainability of business model etc). Post that normal Product slides based on the product - user persona, solutions, prioritisation, and MVP rollout plan

Round 2 - Product Strategy, Product Design [60-90 min]	
Question 1	Why has Whatsapp Payments not taken off in a similar fashion as Gpay, PhonePe, other payments. Suggest some improvements to increase adoption and suggest use-cases
Answer 1	Interviewer was not looking for structure but a free-flowing discussion where they were framing questions on the go. I cited trust and security issues, disadvantages due to being late to market, and the perception of whatsapp as a chat app primarily. Suggested use-cases where whatsapp might be better suited : eg : Similar to splitwise, friends groups on whatsapp; very basic payment interface for tier 3-4 who just use whatsapp etc
Question 2	Suggest OTT improvements for a social experience
Answer 2	Went through circles - but with questions on the go, there were deviations. Suggested ideas like - pausing audio at a momentous scene/ dialogue (ex : 'They don't know, that we know' in Friends), so that those watching can share this moment. Then capturing reactions, allowing chat-audio clips with the streaming etc. Moonshot features like AR/VR where watching a movie together in person could be simulated were also discussed
Advice	They were looking for ideas and how well you can identify pain-points. The usual circles method couldn't be applied as problems were very granular (user personas were defined). Be ready for a conversation, and ready to think on the spot

Round 3 - Behavioural, Go To Market, Product Strategy [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Questions revolved slightly around Gaming industry (mostly because I brought that up). Was given a budget of 5cr and told to distribute it amongst customer acquisition efforts vs customer retention for My11 circle. How would this change pre/post IPL? Follow up-questions about improving customer retention on our platform.
Answer 1	Had read up about the industry so knew about the fact that high-churn rates were a major issue. Interviewer was helpful and did not expect me to know the intricacies of industry, and provided any information asked. A strict bifurcation of budget was not expected - % wise efforts gone into product development & marketing (marketing translated to CAC) was expected.
Question 2	General questions about Why Product Management? What stages are there? What are your expectations etc.
Advice	Read up a little about the industry, competitors, trends etc. Have a basic understanding of a PM's day-to-day activities, what you enjoy among these etc.

Round 4 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	HR round - What excites you about this role? What are you worried about ? Strengths that you can bring to our firm etc.
Answer 1	Answered on the go candidly. Offer was rolled out after this round

Head Digital Works

Company: Head Digital Works

Senior Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
4 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural, Product Strategy [30-60 min]	
Question 1	After the basic introductions, the interviewer picked up one segment (Credit, P2P, BNPL) and started discussing the same. There were back-and-forth questions around the basic functioning of credit cards, BNPL and new developments in this area.
Answer 1	It was a fairly conversational discussion where the interviewer was not grilling but just wanted to know if I knew the basic understanding of the industry.
Question 2	Give an example of a P2P application. How does the matching algorithm work in such applications?
Answer 2	I knew about Cred being one of the P2P applications. I had a rough idea about the matching algorithm which I mentioned in detail from both the sender and the receiver sides. The interviewer was adding inputs and was asking basic questions about the benefits for the application provider and loan providers and the difference between traditional bank loans and P2P loans.
Question 3	How is Cred making money out of it? Is it sustainable?
Answer 3	I knew about the interest rates charged by the banks and used those to compare the benefits for the loan receivers and the commissions charged by application. I also mentioned the benefits of P2P applications for loan receivers in terms of promptness of loan approvals, hassle-free process, etc. From the loan givers' side, the risks are minimal as the funds are crowdsourced and the returns are high.
Advice	Make sure to absorb knowledge about the various industries and their functioning. The industry deep dive sessions organised by BTC were helpful.

Round 2 - Behavioural, Situational, Root Cause Analysis [30-60 min]	
Question 1	RCA question: Imagine you are the PM at Amazon Prime and you notice the viewership dropping by 10% in India.

Answer 1	I followed the basic RCA framework and modified it according to the responses from the interviewer. The interviewer told me that he is changing the path of the discussion as I was nearing the solution just to check if I was asking comprehensive questions. The solution was finally that there was fierce competition between major competitors and competition was attracting the market through better advertisements.
Question 2	The interviewer asked me questions about the company and my understanding about gaming companies and their model.
Answer 2	I had prepared well in advance about the company and was able to answer questions thrown around types of games (skill-based and gambling), conflicts with android around certain games and the intricacies involved to attract and retain customers.
Question 3	Situational: How would you manage conflict in your team and who would have the final say?
Answer 3	There is no right or wrong answer to this question but make sure to prepare certain situational questions in advance in order to answer these questions. One piece of advice would be to not be diplomatic and have a clear answer in mind. For example, I mentioned that if I am leading the team, I will have the final say but would have transparency in the process to arrive at that decision.
Advice	Prepare well about the company and the industry.

Round 3 - Go To Market, Metrics, Root Cause Analysis [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Metrics: How would you measure the success of a new game you launched?
Answer 1	Follow the format for metrics questions and enlist all the possible success, guardrail, and check metrics for the newly launched game. Metrics are really important in the gaming industry, thus make sure to be comprehensive while answering these questions.
Question 2	RCA: The number of .apk file downloads from the HD works website has reduced remarkably. What could be the reason for the same?
Answer 2	Again, follow the framework and ask about all external, and internal factors. Framework is not necessary but it helps to give the discussion a structure and prevents missing out on important questions. The solution was because of an increase in pre-installed games in android phones and the complexity of installing the same using the .apk file.

HiLabs

Company: HiLabs

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
4 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Go To Market, Product Strategy, Metrics [60-90 min]	
Question 1	Introduction
Answer 1	Just briefed about my last company's work and what i did at ISB
Question 2	I was asked to launch a electric bicycle renting App
Answer 2	Asked a couple of clarifying questions so we both have a similar understanding of what was supposed to build. Like What was our parent company, Budget constraints, purpose of designing this product etc, Used simple Marketing Frameworks : Started with 5 C's to Analyse the Market , continued with STP, 4 P's of Product Mix and then strategies to sustain and retain customers. In 4 P's i included most of the product designing, Having used bounce, Vogo etc. I had a clear idea of how things work on the app and how to position the product.
Question 3	What is the North star Metric for success?
Answer 3	Average Number of Rides / week or month. He had a different opinion on this, we had a healthy discussion and finally I was able to convince with my answer. Having read about various metrics of companies and the reasoning behind their north star metric chosen helped. Like here I took reference with Uber which is kinda similar to measuring success.
Advice	Having done little research on the company, I understand that they were more into pricing and GTM strategy so focused more on these aspects. Like for Bike renting app pricing needs to be a function of distance along with time etc.

Round 2 - Product Strategy, Product Design [30-60 min]

Question 1	Asked me to introduce again
Answer 1	gave a brief info highlighting my career achievements which i had prepared already
Question 2	Asked to explain in detail about the Case submitted?
Answer 2	It was more like a discussion.

Round 3 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	This was with their CEO, he asked about why HiLabs? What kind of role would I be willing to take ?
Answer 1	It was conversational

Round 4 - HR Round [0-30 min]	
Question 1	It was a normal HR round. Asked about my preferences in location and salary negotiation.
Answer 1	Conversational

Company: HiLabs

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
4 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Guesstimate, Product Design, Case Discussion [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Walk me through the case you submitted for HiLabs pre-assessment
Answer 1	I had the presentation open and explained each slide. The PM from HiLabs asked a few questions on the feasibility of recommendations and what kind of algorithms will be used in implementing the same.
Question 2	Guesstimate the number of claims and claim amount for an insurance provider in the US.
Answer 2	I took the population approach and further broke it down by age and average number of claims for each age group. Then used the average claim amount for different types of treatments to arrive at the correct number to multiply with the number of claims. The interviewer helped with the numbers as well.
Question 3	Do you know data science Algorithms. Explain a few.
Answer 3	I answered yes and was asked to explain things like K means clustering, naive Bayes, Decision trees and random forest
Advice	Focus on your case. That is a make or break thing for the round. You should know stuff you put in the slides

Round 2 - Situational, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	How will you deal with prioritisation as PM and conflicts within the team
Answer 1	Used the previous experience in agile methodology to talk about keeping reserve capacity for ad hoc requests. You can use the STAR format to narrate a few incidents in which you've tackled similar problems
Question 2	Improve Google maps for Elderly
Answer 2	Used the circle framework and suggested improvements such as a speed-dial for frequently used routes and a tutorial each time the person logs into the app.

Advice	A senior PM is trying to gauge your fitment in the team. Keep the interview conversational and show that you've dealt with similar situations in the past and that you're willing to be an active member of the product teams. Your product prep with Design, RCA etc will help you in this round

Round 3 - Behavioural, Situational, Product Strategy [30-60 min]	
Question 1	How will you price a SaaS product?
Answer 1	Explained the different pricing strategies such as Fixed pricing, Two-part pricing or value based pricing. We had a long discussion on fixed pricing and how it is not the ideal way to price a SaaS product. You need to be aware and show knowledge of product strategy
Question 2	Motivation for joining HiLabs
Answer 2	Behavioural question, needs to be answered based on your profile.
Advice	General product knowledge will help. Look at product strategy questions for this round and be ready for a free flowing conversation with the CEO

Round 4 - Behavioural, Situational [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Tell me about a time when you dealt with a conflict
Answer 1	Used the STAR format
Question 2	Are you a leader or an Individual contributor
Answer 2	As the role is PM, I stressed on my leadership qualities using previous experience

Hilti Technology Solutions

Company: Hilti Technology Solutions

Product Owner

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
2 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Design Uber for old people
Answer 1	Followed the CIRCLES design framework.
Question 2	How will you measure success of your product
Answer 2	Talked about the metrics

Round 2 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Why product owner
Answer 1	talked about my tech background and linked it to the role of product owner tied together with mba knowledge
Question 2	Why Hilti

Housing.com

Company: Housing.com

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Improve Netflix
Answer 1	Followed CIRCLES framework. Cleared the objective of improvement and eventually suggested to improve the recommendation engine

Round 2 - Behavioural [30-60 min]	
Question 1	What's your goal in next 5 years
Answer 1	To be closely associated with startup and PM space. Build something from scratch
Question 2	Why Housing.com?
Answer 2	Its biggest name in real estate space and after the acquisition by REA, Housing is in right shape to have a stable job

Round 3 - HR Round [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Questions around expected compensation
Answer 1	Told the expectation

Jio

Company: Jio

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Problem Solving [60-90 min]	
Question 1	I was given a supply chain related situation and the interview was just around that case. Myntra has stopped delivery orders through air as it was very costly, but still want to maintain fast delivery so that they don't lose customers. How?
Answer 1	Talked about setting up a hub and spoke model, having shared warehouses at different locations.
Advice	Knowledge from OPMG helped a lot in this. The interviewer was guiding through the process.

Round 2 - Product Strategy [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Pick a Jio product and compare it with competitors. What is good, what is bad?
Question 2	How will you market it to get more users?
Question 3	What are your strengths and weaknesses?
Advice	Read about all their products and try using it. I was not given time to think, he wanted me to just say things out loud.

Round 3 - Behavioural, Situational [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Tell me about yourself, Talk about a difficult situation. How would you do it differently
Question 2	What other things apart from work do I do?
Advice	General Q&A. Know your resume properly

Company: Jio

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Favourite Product [60-90 min]	
Question 1	Tell me about your favourite product and how will you improve it?
Answer 1	I prepared my favourite product. I spent time making the interviewer understand what the app does as it was one of the niche mobile apps. The product was actually something which I use daily hence, I could talk about it passionately. I had a major discussion around the type of customers of the app and targeted customer segment which I belong to. I later listed all the pain points I face on the app along with the suggestions to improve it. The interviewer asked for prioritisation of the suggested improvements along with the reasoning. Next major discussion was around metrics of the suggested features. Interviewer also asked the GTM of these features.

Round 2 - Product Design [60-90 min]	
Question 1	Tell me about yourself briefly
Answer 1	I covered my experience with a focus on product management-related projects/activities (across tech, marketing, and consulting) I have done in the past. The interviewer discussed a couple of stellar projects I mentioned.
Question 2	Design smart refrigerator for Jio so that it becomes market leader.
Answer 2	I started with scoping questions. What is the meaning of smart? do we have any customer segment in mind? and other similar questions. Followed the CIRCLES framework to make this. I selected Children as the target segment. It includes flavour of parents involvement as well. Discuss various pain points and prioritise the major ones in discussion with the interviewer. Made features for the pain points using IoT, sensors, app, hardwares, etc. Designed metrics of the features for the prioritised features. Interviewer focused a lot on the prioritisation and its reasoning. Later the Interviewer also asked for GTM of the features and marketing campaign examples. I used my customised marketing framework to prepare GTM along with slogans and collar suggestions in the campaign.
Question 3	Do you have any questions for me?

Answer 3	I asked the interviewer about different product lines and how a new PM is allocated a service line. I also asked her how the handholding is done for the PM to get onboarded in the team
Advice	Start the prep with BTC Handbook and read all the interview experiences of that or a similar company from the handbook when shortlisted. Prepare metrics well for all the interviews, which will help you in the long run.

Round 3 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Tell me about yourself? Why PM
Answer 1	I had prepared this question for the HR interview. Along with technical and PM skills try to showcase your team working style and other soft skills you possess.
Question 2	Why MBA? Why Jio? What do you bring to the table?
Answer 2	This round was taken by HR. I have prepared these behavioural questions through different resources mentioned in the BTC handbook. For why Jio, relate your previous work ex. to Jio and how your aspirations will be met in Jio.

Company: Jio

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural, Guesstimate, Go To Market [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Compare YouTube music with Amazon music and improve YouTube music.
Answer 1	Don't remember
Question 2	Puzzle questions- a man moves 2 step forward and 1 step back one after after the other, in how many min movements will he reach to 15th step.
Answer 2	27

Round 2 - Product Strategy [30-60 min]	
Question 1	JioMart Supply chain- end to end analysis asked
Answer 1	Focus on demand forecasting and inventory management. Think as a PM and not as an operations manager.

Round 3 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	End to end CV BASED behavioural question. Why Jio, explain the switches, going in detail about the impact.
Answer 1	N/A

Company: Jio

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Situational, Root Cause Analysis, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Favourite product improvement
Answer 1	Approached through typical product design framework: Modified CIRCLES
Question 2	No. of users dropped in a particular section in my favourite app - RCA
Question 3	Tell me about a time when you handled conflict
Advice	basic product framework knowledge (BTC Handbook, Decode & Conquer) + Mocks

Round 2 - Behavioural, Situational, Product Strategy, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Product Strategy Question
Answer 1	Used framework among other things
Question 2	Product Design Question
Question 3	Behavioural Question
Advice	Mocks will help

Round 3 - Behavioural, Situational [0-30 min]	
Question 1	HR Round
Answer 1	Questions about me, my resume, etc.
Advice	Mocks, Elevator pitch

Company: Jio

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Go To Market, Product Strategy, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Design 5G tech based application for Jio
Answer 1	I designed an application to help engineers resolve manufacturing issues remotely
Question 2	What is product management?
Answer 2	Intersection of business, design and technical aspect of product that solves a specific problem for particular cohorts of personas
Question 3	Which Product do you like? Suggest feature improvements and design GTM.
Answer 3	Spotify. Suggested features, prioritised a single one and prepared GTM strategy
Advice	Start Reading PM related books earlier, practise cases and implement feedback

Round 2 - Behavioural, Go To Market, Problem Solving, Product Strategy, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Describe your job role?
Answer 1	I answered the question and highlighted top PM skills like stakeholder management, product development and innovation in the answer
Question 2	Build an App (Product Design) for Toastmasters International
Answer 2	The question was asked because I had TM on my resume. It involved defining product objective, Problem, customer segments, product design
Question 3	Building on the product design question, I was asked how would I communicate the product feature to an engineer and designer
Answer 3	I drew parallelism with existing app features wherever possible for both stakeholders.

Advice	Practising cases, clear communication highlighting multi-dimensions is very important

Round 3 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Why MBA?
Answer 1	I answered by creating a story of my past work-ex, my short-term vision to do an MBA and how the company can leverage from it
Question 2	Tell me about your family members?
Answer 2	Answered in short
Question 3	Tell me three people you have impacted, you may give personal examples as well
Answer 3	Answered and told a short story for the most impactful one
Advice	Preparing for behaviour is equally important. Read as many questions as possible and think of bullet points. Practising questions with friends is very important to remain crisp and interesting during an interview.

Jivox

Company: Jivox

Customer Success Manager

Product Marketing
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Ad Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Design a dynamic ad creative for Cereal company
Answer 1	Designed the dynamic ad and discussed parameters like text, headline, weather, location, demo etc

Round 2 - Behavioural [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Since I had digital marketing work ex, questions were around my work ex
Answer 1	I was asked to compare performance marketing vs brand marketing

Round 3 - CEO Round [0-30 min]	
Question 1	A general conversation round with CEO of Jivox
Answer 1	We both described our journey

Keka

Company: Keka

Product Manager

Job Offered - No
2 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	I was grilled on the case submission and had to explain my thought process. They checked how I was able to design solutions based on the questions.
Answer 1	I backed my answers citing consumer insights I had gathered, how I understood the problem to be. It will also happen though that oftentimes they will challenge and cross question you on your solution. In this situation, just be confident, listen clearly, take some time and then respond.
Question 2	How did I work as a PM? What was the team size? How many designers?
Answer 2	I think they wanted to know how hands-on I was as a PM. They basically wanted process level info on my working which I shared with them.

Round 2 - Behavioural, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	This round was with the CEO directly. He asked me why I wanted to be a PM, why MBA, what have I learnt, etc.
Answer 1	I related this answer based on my past experience working as a QA and what I learnt from working there and what made me pivot to a PM role.
Question 2	He then asked me questions on my case submission. I justified how my solution solved the problem given. He asked me to pick a single solution.
Answer 2	I first gave justification for the proposed solution. Afterwards, when asked to pick a single solution, I suggested gathering some data before picking a solution. I later on got to know that he wanted me.to pin point and select a solution. He wanted to know my decision making ability in the absence of data. I wasn't able to anticipate it during the interview. So when interviewing, try to understand more about what the interviewer is looking for.
Advice	Be a better listener. Interviews with CEOs are a great way to learn.

Media.net

Company: Media.net

Associate Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - No
4 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Product Design, Case Discussion [>90 min]	
Question 1	Case study on increasing engagement acquisition of Travel reviews website
Answer 1	Acquisition - target PwD persons, Business Travellers and Review Communities
Advice	Think of unique solutions

Round 2 - Behavioural, Situational, Guesstimate [60-90 min]	
Question 1	What is NPS
Answer 1	Net Promoter Score, describe
Question 2	Describe Database to a 5 year old
Answer 2	Toy Store example
Question 3	Guesstimate - no of weddings in India in December
Advice	Calm and confident

Round 3 - Go To Market, Product Design [60-90 min]	
Question 1	Redesign Skip Ad button on YouTube
Answer 1	Work to solve current limitations
Question 2	GTM Strategy for above question
Question 3	On general understanding of digital media and advertising technology
Advice	Read up on digital media

Round 4 - Situational, Metrics, Root Cause Analysis [60-90 min]	
Question 1	Uber Root Cause Analysis for drop in rides availed/booked
Answer 1	Wanted all possible reasons. Define the formula for the metric
Question 2	Design a dashboard for Ola CEO
Answer 2	Do not deep dive into way too many metrics
Question 3	Guesstimate - CPC of ad posted for a flight going from Mumbai to Hyderabad on MakeMyTrip
Answer 3	Guesstimate approach

Company: Media.net

Associate Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - No
4 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Go To Market, Product Strategy, Product Design [>90 min]	
Question 1	Elaborate 2-part case study based on Tripadvisor - new features, new revenue streams, revenue projection of 3 years etc
Answer 1	Prepared word-doc to answer all the questions

Round 2 - Guesstimate [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Find the number of Petrol Pumps that should be required to suffice's Delhi's traffic in next 2 years
Answer 1	-Calculated vehicles in Delhi-NCR based on Household & income presently. -Public Transport & Cabs as a percentage of pvt vehicles - Mileage per 2-wheeler/4-wheeler * kms to calculate fuel requirement. - Divide by amt of petrol in petrol pumps to find final number - Population growth rate (increase) and a % decrease rate due to penetration of EVs was factored in Interviewer was looking for clear-cut assumptions. I had missed diesel CNGs, which he pointed out and suggested I assume only petrol. He was supplying all relevant details like mileage of cars, petrol capacity of petrol pumps etc. He was looking for EV penetration, which I had missed initially and specifically asked, if there will be just an increase in an urban are alike Delhi, which is when I took that into account

Round 3 - Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Imagine you are Apple in the 1990s. Design a communication device for the visually impaired.
Answer 1	Applied circles - scope was very narrow. After clarifying questions, I had to suggest only communication related features (calling and SMS) for completely blind people. Identified pain-points and designed solutions - haptic controls for SMS,

	text-to-speech for SMS, voice-based dialling etc.

Round 4 - Root Cause Analysis [30-60 min]	
Question 1	There has been an 80% drop in Viewership on Netflix. Identify reasons.Think of the interviewer as a Database. You can ask questions only in the form of queries (not in SQL, but in words ; e.g. instead of asking Does this concern a particular geography I had to ask : If we partition this data by country, are we observing any trend?)
Answer 1	Was able to arrive at the solution, but had not explored the external factors well. It became challenging to ask questions and I lost sight of the structure when I got closer to the solution. ex : If I wanted to ask whether this was an issue with indian viewers or Indian geography, I had to formulate it as : if country == India and nationality!=Indian or country!=India and nationality==Indian, do we observe the same results as country==India and nationality==Indian.
Question 2	Some puzzle on picking a number and arriving at a specified number
Answer 2	Was able to solve it partially (recursive solution)

Microsoft

Company: Microsoft

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - No
4 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Case Discussion [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Traditional libraries are on the verge of extinction. Suggest a solution to deal with this problem. Write a word document in 20 mins and then present it immediately.
Answer 1	I went for the metaverse approach where there will be a virtual library with few basic and few out-of-the-box features. While presenting, I started with traditional libraries and then audiobooks, and finally virtual libraries. I emphasised on the gaps between every transition and consumer behaviour change, demand change, etc.

Round 2 - Product Design [60-90 min]	
Question 1	How would you deal with fake reviews on Amazon?
Answer 1	First of all, we need to clarify with the interviewer what fake reviews are. Then, I suggested 3-4 real use cases where fake reviews can happen like marketers giving money to people to write fake reviews to suppress competitive brands, brands sending money along with the amazon parcel to write fake reviews, etc. I suggested solutions like keeping a threshold on reviews from one account and tracking the background information while verifying the reviews.
Advice	Talk to the interviewer, try to get subtle hints, and give a logical explanation.

Round 3 - Product Design [60-90 min]	
Question 1	Design a health product for migrants living in a camp.
Answer 1	We discussed the problem statement thoroughly for an hour and didn't even reach the solution part. I started by segregating health issues into physical, mental, long-term/serious, etc. Then, again I considered multiple stakeholders like migrants, admin staff and doctors, government, etc., and their pain points.

	This was a long discussion where the interviewer wanted me to consider all the pain points of all the stakeholders.

Round 4 - Behavioural [60-90 min]	
Question 1	Explain big data to 6-year-olds.
Answer 1	I took an example of a playground with just one small gate. Then, I explained how easy it is for 50 students to enter that playground and how hard it is for 1 lakh students to enter. So, we can have multiple playgrounds and distribute students. I tried to explain the distributed computation of big data through this example.
Question 2	Explain SQL queries to 6-year-olds.
Answer 2	I took an example of a mother, a child, and a bowl of chocolates. I explained the "where" clause and "select" query by asking the child to select chocolates from the bowl with different conditions.
Question 3	How would you make sure there is synergy between third-party teams and your development team?
Answer 3	I couldn't answer this question properly. I just said training, product knowledge, transparency, proper distribution of the tasks, etc. need to be done to maintain the synergy.

Company: Microsoft

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - No
3 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Improve Spotify
Answer 1	Followed CIRCLES framework to eventually suggest shazam integration with spotify

Round 2 - Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Design an app for patient registration for hospital receptionist
Answer 1	Followed CIRCLES framework

MPS Ltd.

Company: MPS Ltd.

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
4 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural, Go To Market, Product Strategy, Metrics [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Design Go To Market Strategy for the Product in a New Geography
Answer 1	NA

Round 2 - Behavioural, Situational [0-30 min]	
Question 1	CV Based. Went into nitty gritty of CV
Answer 1	NA

Round 3 - Behavioural, Product Strategy [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Company related. How do you plan to work on specific aspects of the product strategy for MPS Ltd.
Answer 1	NA

Round 4 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Fitment round. How well do you fit with the company culture, expectations.
Answer 1	NA

Nagarro

Company: Nagarro

Delivery (Scrum Master)

Program Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural, Situational, Behavioural [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Tell us something interesting about you
Answer 1	Started with personal instances that covered characteristics needed to be a successful manager and ended with some professional examples
Question 2	Strengths, weaknesses and situational questions
Answer 2	Answered in a STAR format and there were a lot of follow-ups to each answer
Advice	Focus on building up an integrated personal and professional story, and know your previous work in depth. Prepare answers to behavioural and situational questions beforehand and practice them well

Round 2 - Behavioural, Situational, General [30-60 min]	
Question 1	What are some of the latest disruptions in tech
Answer 1	This round was with the CTO and it was more of a discussion around the latest tech like AR/VR, quantum computing, engaged OTT etc. The discussion lasted for about 40 mins.
Question 2	What do you value in a company and reasons for joining
Answer 2	Explained my thought process and reasons for choosing a company

Round 3 - HR Round [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Basic HR questions
Answer 1	General answers

Company: Nagarro

Business Consultant - Advertising Domain

Tech Consulting
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural, Situational, Product Strategy, Root Cause Analysis, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Resume-based questions, explain how you have achieved so and so, previous experience, etc
Answer 1	Being aware of the lines written in the resume and prepping for such questions will be helpful.
Advice	Research about the company culture and prep for Culture fit questions

Round 2 - Situational, Go To Market, Root Cause Analysis [0-30 min]	
Question 1	What is your favourite subject at ISB, and why?
Answer 1	I have answered Marketing and explained how Markstrat was a real life example of corporate decision making.

Navi

Company: Navi

Associate Product Manager

Job Offered - Yes
2 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural, Product Strategy, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Favourite fintech product? Why? How would you improve it?
Answer 1	Answered PhonePe and gave reasons. Followed CIRCLES for improvement
Question 2	What should Paytm do to attract loyal PhonePe users onto their platform?
Question 3	Simple question on metrics. Followed by why PM?
Advice	Structure matters. They gave higher weightage to structure than solutions.

Round 2 - Behavioural, Product Strategy, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Consider there are only 2 players (Swiggy and Zomato) in the food delivery space and each of them has 50% market share. How can Swiggy capture 80% market share?
Answer 1	Clarified and scoped down. Market share can be gained 1. Squeezing more out of the existing market (Taking away business from competition or increasing revenue from our current customers), 2. New market creation. Was asked to focus on the existing market. Divided the problem in 3 buckets - supply side (restaurants), delivery partners, and demand side. Listed down uber level initiatives in each bucket that can help us achieve the goal of increasing the market share. Was asked to focus on the demand side.
Question 2	Why PM? Why Navi?
Answer 2	Basic behavioural.

Nium

Company: Nium

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - No
2 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Create a service that detects meeting conflicts
Answer 1	Followed CIRCLES
Question 2	GTM strategy for the service that was just designed
Answer 2	Answered
Question 3	Tell me about a time when you had to convince someone to do something. Tell me about a time when you had to deal with a lot of ambiguity Looking back tell me about a situation in which you'd do a bit differently
Answer 3	Answered
Advice	Be foolproof in your clarifying questions. I assumed a few things at the start of the 1st question and the interviewer stopped me mid-day to point that out

Company: Nium

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - No
3 rounds of which 2 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Improve Google Maps
Answer 1	Followed CIRCLES framework to eventually suggest integration of Park plus with google maps
Advice	Be thorough with design questions and suggest some innovative solutions

Round 2 - Guesstimate [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Guesstimate the number of coffee sold in starbucks in India per day
Answer 1	Started with the population of India then cut the population by demography, geography, and coffee drinkers. Eventually made a key assumption that 5 out of 10 people around me drink coffee and 1 of them drinks starbucks coffee
Advice	Be thorough with basic guesstimates

Round 3 - Behavioural, Situational [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Why PM?
Answer 1	My pre ISB role was product marketing manager and now I want to become PM
Question 2	Why NIUM?
Answer 2	Want to be closely associated with the payment industry. My pre ISB company was also a Fintech
Question 3	What all parameters you would consider to fraud check engine for NIUM
Answer 3	IP, Geo, Frequency of payment, etc
Advice	Be thorough with questions like Why PM and Why NIUM

Company: Nium

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Situational, Go To Market, Product Strategy, Root Cause Analysis [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Should Nium get into the insurance industry in India?
Answer 1	I started with some clarifying questions such as type of insurance, objective etc. This is a product strategy (market entry) case & I answered this question based on the following factors : market attractiveness, competitors, feasibility, & the company's mission. I finally recommended that Nium should not enter the insurance business.
Question 2	Transactions in Nium have decreased recently, how will you go about it?
Answer 2	I started with some clarifying questions & divided my response into external & internal causes. This is a standard RCA case & the interviewer was mostly interested in the approach and not the final root cause.
Question 3	How would developers rate you out of 5?
Answer 3	I answered 4 out of 5 and explained the reasons why. I used reasons such as alignment with the company's mission, external factors such as client pressure to justify why they won't rate me 5/5.
Advice	Read about the company & practise the RCA and product strategy questions

Round 2 - Product Strategy [30-60 min]	
Question 1	How should Nium venture into Crypto?
Answer 1	I used the standard framework of market entry to answer this question (Market attractiveness, feasibility & financial viability) followed by some red flags
Question 2	What are the customer touch points while implementing a new idea?
Answer 2	I spoke of customer interviews, A/B testing, metrices, survey & secondary research and explained them in logical order of product development
Question 3	NA

Round 3 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Why Nium?
Answer 1	I leveraged my past work experience in the fintech industry to convince HR. Try to make it personalised
Question 2	Ask anything about Nium?
Answer 2	I had prepared 3 questions before the interview & asked those

Company: Nium

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural, Situational, Guesstimate, Product Strategy, Metrics, Root Cause Analysis, Product Design [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Design an app for a theme park. How would you monetise it?
Answer 1	Apply CIRCLES. Pick a key user segment for which the app is actually creating value. See the ways to capture and communicate that value to the user.
Question 2	Few questions on pre Isb experience and my ISB experience
Advice	Yes

Round 2 - Behavioural, Situational, Guesstimate [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Estimate the size of the fintech market in the world.
Answer 1	Start with Mece and estimate the size of the fintech market in India. Then extrapolate it to the world.
Question 2	Too many questions about the company and their products.
Answer 2	This will be rapid fire so read the website and LinkedIn really well.
Advice	Yes

Round 3 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Normal behaviour questions, CTC expectations.
Answer 1	Although this round was eliminative, the interviewer simply focussed on why one should join them. Asked about other offers and CTC expectations.
Advice	No, just connect with the interviewer.

Nykaa

Company: Nykaa

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
5 rounds of which 2 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Metrics, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	What are your 5 favourite products(LinkedIn one of them). LinkedIn D7 retention went down (60% -> 40%). How to improve?
Answer 1	Clarified and scoped the question. Structured and listed out the possible reasons why user retention is going down. The interviewer asked me to pick one of the reasons (picked – posts on the feed are not adding value) and list all the metrics needed to determine if that was the root cause. Now I was asked to assume that this is the actual reason and I needed to figure out a way to improve this. Followed CIRCLES after this point.
Advice	Structure matters. When preparing for interviews give higher weightage to structure than solutions

Round 2 - Behavioural, Metrics, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	How will you solve for paradox of choice in Myntra
Answer 1	Clarified and scoped down. Listed down 2 experiments that I can run and metrics that I can track to identify the paradox of choice (choice paralysis) on Myntra. For example, one experiment was – A/B test with the test sample having less selection on the home page(HP). Hypothesised that merchandising visits on HP will have a lower conversion if the paradox of choice existed. Search visits conversion shouldn't vary much between the control and test. Listed down a few more metrics to gauge the problem
Question 2	After running these experiments you confirm that the paradox of choice exists on Myntra. How would you solve it?
Answer 2	Followed CIRCLES

Round 3 - Behavioural, Product Design [30-60 min]

Question 1	Design a new-age airport experience
Answer 1	Followed by CIRCLES method. The interviewer was not interested in the solution. He asked me to detail out the complete user journey of all the stakeholders involved. He was interested in the details. Was testing user empathy and structure
Question 2	Least favourite product and why
Answer 2	Answered
Question 3	Why PM? And few generic behavioural questions

Paytm

Company: Paytm

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Case Discussion [>90 min]	
Question 1	RCA case on Paytm sales agent application. Sales agents were leaving the job after a month. We had to find RCA with the help of data given in the case and our own research and give suggestions to reduce it.
Answer 1	I spoke to sales agents of Paytm through my contacts and understood the entire architecture of the PSA application. I got to know their exact pain points and gave my suggestions accordingly.

Round 2 - Case Discussion [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Introduce yourself.
Answer 1	I gave a brief introduction of myself mentioning college, work experience, hobbies, etc.
Question 2	Present the case deck that we had submitted.
Answer 2	There were 3 slides regarding pain points, solutions, and prioritisation & metrics, etc. I told the entire story of the market research that I had done and explained my solutions. I kept on asking whether it was too fast or too technical, took pauses in between, etc.

Round 3 - Product Strategy [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Technical question - data structure linked list and circular linked list
Answer 1	I had prepared data structures. I answered 2-3 questions. I was not able to answer the last question. It was deletion, insertion of a circular linked list. Prepare basic operations of data structures.
Question 2	If you have to launch Google maps and Youtube, which one will you launch

	first?
Answer 2	I did a comparative analysis of both products on three factors: consumer demand, competition, and technical feasibility. I went for Google maps as it had a stronger need and more revenue channels. Youtube will take some time to grow as content creators need to join the platform. You can go for any option if you are able to justify your answer properly.
Question 3	Basic Puzzle questions
Answer 3	I was able to answer most of the questions. These were common puzzle questions that are asked in any interview.

Company: Paytm

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Case Discussion [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Walkthrough of the written case submission. Problem statement for the case was “ As the PM, your objective is to come up with a roadmap to increase the productivity of the sales network (PSA- Paytm service agents)”
Answer 1	Gave a walkthrough of the case submitted during preliminary case round covering : assumptions, insights from the data provided in the case, user persona, user journey, pain points, solutions with prioritisation followed by roadmap, release plan and key metrics and then answered some follow up questions on the solutions I suggested.
Advice	Do the product case prep and be ready to justify any questions on the case submission.

Round 2 - Product Strategy [0-30 min]	
Question 1	This round was to understand my story telling skills and business sense. I was asked to introduce myself and tell a story about my journey up till ISB as well as my future goals and aspirations. Then I was given 5 minutes to think about and answer 3 questions. Question 1) Why is it that in most markets we see that only one or two large players survive , for example Uber and Ola or Amazon and Flipkart? What happens to the other players?
Answer 1	For the introduction they were mainly looking for a unique and concise answer. I took a minute to gather my thoughts and spoke passionately about my journey and goals. For the first answer I took the example of Uber and basically talked about everything we had read about Uber’s strategy in case studies covered in classes as well as the platform model taught in SDEC (for example how Uber increases switching costs for drivers, etc).
Question 2	2) take any two platforms and tell me why you would choose one over the other
Answer 2	I picked Swiggy over Zomato and talked about a few product features but mainly focused on their overall strategy and vision since this round was more about assessing the business sense and not just PM skills. I mentioned how Swiggy leveraged its delivery network and launched Genie during COVID,

	about how they ventured into healthcare which is aligned with their strengths.
Question 3	3) if you were the PM at Ola, what would you do if you saw that Uber's market share is increasing ?
Answer 3	They were looking for business related solutions and not product specific solutions or features, for example I talked about targeting new customer segments or diversifying into new product categories (like Ola Pay) etc.
Advice	Read tech blogs, articles; Be aware about the major players (Amazon, Uber, Google, etc.) and what they are doing, where they are headed.

Razorpay

Company: Razorpay

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Product Design [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Improve the revenue of Zoom.
Answer 1	Followed CIRCLES framework. Clarified the main goal and asked some follow-up questions. Also talked about the competition of Zoom. Then chose a user segment, went ahead with a B2C approach as Zoom already flourished in B2B space. I chose user segment with a disposable income. Then went ahead with four pain-points, prioritised one based on the user journey. Went into the user journey at this stage. After that, I came up with four solutions: one "hackathon" (quick), one moonshot, and two regular. Always went back to the goal for each solution. Prioritised using RICE and spoke about metrics (L0, L1, L2). Also briefly did a go-to-market.

Round 2 - Product Design [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Reduce the traffic congestion in Bangalore.
Answer 1	Narrowed down the scope as much as I could: down to time-of-day, geography, vehicle type, etc. Once this was done, clarified which metric can we even use to measure traffic congestion, and focused on optimising that. After this, it was mostly CIRCLES again. I chose a user type: young engineers based on TAM and growth rate. Then their pain-points, prioritised one, came up with features for them, and prioritised the features using RICE. Interviewer went very deep into the metrics, so had to further come up with 10 metrics to measure success. Also a quick GTM at the end.

Round 3 - Product Strategy, Product Design [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Improve revenue of WhatsApp.
Answer 1	This sounded like a question that I did in practice but actually the expectations were very different. Interviewer made it clear he wanted a combination of

	strategic and design thinking for this. First started with the goal of increasing revenue. The problem here is that WhatsApp is primarily a communications platform but also does have some forms of payments. Discussed all the ways WhatsApp currently makes revenue and the strengths/drawbacks of each. Then spoke extensively about the competition WhatsApp faces in both the communication and finance domains. Focused on a new way of increasing revenue that does not already exist leveraging WhatsApp's strengths and is difficult for the competition to replicate. I chose a user segment based on TAM and revenue potential: merchants on WhatsApp. Looked into their pain-points and focused on one based on willingness-to-pay if that problem was solved. Then came up with four solutions to address this problem, and prioritised one using RICE. It was important for me to include why the competition cannot mimic our solution during the prioritisation section. Finally I ended up pitching an e-commerce site on WhatsApp. Looked at metrics (L0, L1, L2). Also quickly did a GTM. This was a very long question and the interviewer had follow-up questions at almost every turn, so I was running out of time and had to rush through some parts. But I called out that I was running out of time and would rush some things like GTM, and he was fine with that.

Company: Razorpay

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural, Product Strategy, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Walk me through your resume
Answer 1	Standard question, followed the Past-Present-Future structure to answer the question
Question 2	You are a PM at Swiggy and you have been tasked to come up with solutions to increase the revenue of Swiggy App. How would you go about it?
Answer 2	The question initially sounded ambiguous, however, after going through the clarification questions, it came out to be a design/strategy question where the interviewer wanted me to think of new features and improvements in the current system to improve revenue. Followed the standard CIRCLES structure, chose small businesses as the target market and gave 4-5 pain points along with solutions for the top 2 pain points. Talked about the prioritisation of features and tradeoffs
Advice	First round at Razorpay is usually a standard design/strategy round and sufficient practice of such question types should work.

Round 2 - Situational, Product Strategy [60-90 min]	
Question 1	How would you improve monetization of Instagram?
Answer 1	This question looked fairly simple at the beginning but turned out to be one of the toughest interviews I gave due to constant cross questioning. Had made a personalised framework to answer such questions: Clarifying questions, Company Vision, Strategic objective, market attractiveness (Can I build xx to monetize or not?), Features, GTM and Risks associated with the strategy I was constantly questioned on the segment I had selected (I divided the users into creators and consumers and chose creators to monetize) Gave a revenue sharing model between creators and Instagram using new features like Masterclasses, Fan exclusive access to content and Youtube like

	donations It was a stress interview which was take by a junior PM who worked under the Director PM who took my round 1
Advice	Monetization questions with ambiguous problem statements was a common theme in Razorpay interviews, practise such questions from Exponent, Youtube etc. to gain confidence

Round 3 - Behavioural, Situational [60-90 min]	
Question 1	Walk me through your resume
Answer 1	Standard question, interviewer was extremely impressed with my prior PM experience and entrepreneurial stint
Question 2	Favourite Product, 1 good thing and 1 bad thing about that product
Answer 2	Chose BBInstant as my favourite product, talked about ease of use associated with a digital vending machine. Suggested child friendly feature to automatically dispense products at a lower height instead of opening doors and taking out the product
Question 3	A situation where you failed as a PM? 1 thing you dislike about being a PM? How would you manage a situation where the team does not agree to a feature that you propose?
Answer 3	I talked about a failure during my prior PM experience, the interviewer was happy with the story and was able to relate to my experience. Answered other questions very candidly and honestly from my past experience
Advice	This round was the best PM interview for me. Being candid and open was the key for this round. Post interview had a nice discussion on scaling and growing startups where the interviewer explained some of the pain points of Razorpay customers and I deep dived into figuring out ways to solve the problem in a scalable and sustainable way

Company: Razorpay

Product Marketing Manager

Product Marketing
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Go To Market [30-60 min]	
Question 1	A brief introduction about self and then straight into Case. Providence has a new hospital management software. How would you market it? Also what features do u think the product should have. Wanted detailed understanding of whom to target.
Answer 1	Started by understanding all the people that visit hospitals and work there. Broke down their basic needs to function smoothly in the hospital and then listed out the TGs and the features to meet the needs. I did prioritise here. Interviewers mentioned the feature of health records on the s/w for patients with a history at the hospital was missing. I agreed this should be added to the S/w to avoid patients from carrying too many folders and to have a proper record available for the doc. Then the GTM strategy - STP and 4Ps. They asked me a few questions on my proposal like why direct mkt etc.
Advice	Especially for Razorpay GTM role - 1. The interviews are case heavy. 2. Practice design questions from the PM prep book. You are tested on design thinking. In general tips - 1. Keep a track of what mistakes or gaps interviewers highlight and remember them for the next round. 2. Also keep checking in with the interviewers if what you are suggesting is making sense. Ask clarifying questions without hesitation. 3. And DO NOT memorise your 'thank you for the question' and 'I would like to take a minute to think'. Will not make or break your interview but it is the impression that you create which also matters.

Round 2 - Product Design [60-90 min]	
Question 1	You are a part of the HDFC team who wants to increase the retention of HNI

	customers (30+ years of age) by building a money management app for their kids (5-15 y.o) . Focus on how you will ensure loyalty and stickiness towards the app and how you will use it to acquire more HNI customers.
Answer 1	After a few clarifying questions, I broke down the TG w.r.t kids and their parents. Created different personas and prioritised one of them with proper reasoning. Then broke down user flows into 3 parts - Planning, spending and tracking. Post that focused on what ideas can be explored to improve the stickiness. Answered their questions post this.
Advice	My PM prep was very handy here as user flows, customer pain points, user personas are a very important part of it. These skills helped me deliver what the interviewers were looking for, which is how well do you identify the needs of the customers and how would you meet those needs.

Round 3 - Situational [30-60 min]	
Question 1	It was behavioural and situational. We talked about hobbies, things not mentioned in the resume as well and certain scenarios where the interviewer wanted to understand my thought process.
Answer 1	This was not an HR round.
Advice	Be prepared with your behavioural questions. Since you are so close to the finale, don't let that get to your head. Tackle this one interview at a time and in case of curve balls thrown, ask questions, and make sure you understand correctly before you respond.

Company: Razorpay

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - No
3 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Product Design [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Design a yoga app. (I mentioned that my favourite hobby was yoga and hence was asked to design an app for it)
Answer 1	Followed the CIRCLES approach. I started with some basic clarifying questions, then defined the goal and vision of the app. I took a pause to come up with 3-4 segments such as newbies, regular practitioners , professionals etc and prioritised one user segment. While prioritising I made sure to tie it back to the goal defined in the beginning. Then I took another pause to come up with the needs/ pain points as well as solutions, prioritisation and metrics. After listing 3-4 pain points, I was asked to straight away jump to solutions and give any one feature I would like to include in the app and a metric for it.
Advice	Practice product design cases . In this interview, I was only allowed to take 2 pauses so I practised a few cases in the same way during case prep as well. Also, don't take long pauses and keep the interviewee engaged.

Round 2 - Product Design [0-30 min]	
Question 1	What is your favourite product and favourite hobby? I answered that my favourite product is WhatsApp and my hobby is yoga. I was asked to design something for yoga enthusiasts on WhatsApp.
Answer 1	Started with clarifying questions to understand the problem statement well, talked about WhatsApp’s mission and why building this would make sense for WhatsApp, picked WhatsApp for business and defined the target audience as yoga studio owners who want to go online after covid and then followed the same approach for product design. Also mentioned risks and how to mitigate them.
Advice	Give mock interviews and try to keep them conversational.

Round 3 - Behavioural, Situational, Go To Market [0-30 min]

Question 1	This was like a rapid fire round with lots of questions and very little time to think about the answers. I was asked some resume related questions, 3 things I love about PM and one thing I hate about PM, pick a dream company (except Razorpay) and why, GTM question - how would I launch a language app in the market , what are the channels I would pick to promote it and many more questions.
Answer 1	I answered each question as it came. Basically be well prepared with resume questions and why you want to be PM. Also do GTM case prep.

Company: Razorpay

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - No
3 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Go To Market, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Design a tablet for school students
Answer 1	Followed CIRCLES framework. Also discussed the physical design of tablet i.e. it should fit in bag, robust design, etc
Question 2	Devise GTM strategy for tablet
Answer 2	Discussed different GTM channels like tie up with school, digital marketing to students, door to door marketing etc

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Shipsy

Company: Shipsy

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - No
4 rounds of which 2 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Identify the biggest challenges that Spotify is facing and which one will you pick first to solve
Answer 1	Followed CIRCLES
Question 2	Why PM? Why Shipsy?
Advice	Structure matters. When preparing for interviews give higher weightage to structure than solutions

Round 2 - Behavioural, Metrics, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	How will you design a system for determining ETAs for food deliveries?
Answer 1	Clarified and scoped the question. Established the objective and listed out factors in a structured way to estimate delivery ETAs. Was asked to pick one factor (picked distance b/w restaurant & DP) and to list out ways in leveraging this factor to improve ETA.
Question 2	Favourite product and improvement.
Answer 2	Answered
Question 3	Why PM?

Sprinklr

Company: Sprinklr

Product Marketing Manager

Product Marketing
Job Offered - Yes
4 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Go To Market [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Tell me about yourself
Answer 1	Resume walkthrough + personal experiences
Question 2	What would you do to increase the number of female customers in JCB's customer base
Answer 2	Viability of focusing on the segment (Profitability analysis) Partnership with government to introduce subsidies Customising elements of the product Special training and handholding sessions

Round 2 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	What do you know about Sprinklr?
Answer 1	Read about the company's vision and product offerings on their website and other available resources
Question 2	Tell me about yourself

Round 3 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Weakness
Answer 1	Low risk appetite Working on taking calculated risks
Question 2	Tell me about yourself
Question 3	What do you know about Sprinklr

Round 4 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	What are your absolute no nos at work
Answer 1	Being forced to do something without understanding the Whys Toxic work culture

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Tata Digital

Company: Tata Digital

Product Manager 2

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Product Strategy, Root Cause Analysis [30-60 min]	
Question 1	What are your views on Tata Digital's super app Tata Neu? Have you made any transactions in the app?
Answer 1	I had done my research on the app and could talk in depth about the super app. Talked about its competitors, market needs, offerings, etc. I had not made any transactions in Tata Neu, which I told the interviewer.
Question 2	Suppose you are the PM of the fashion category in Tata Neu, and you see one day that the DAU has dropped by 10%. What would you do?
Answer 2	Talked about how I would do the root cause analysis. Started with external factors, then internal factors. Listed out all the possibilities that could cause the drop.
Question 3	Do you know the concept of SNBL (Save Now, Buy Later)? How can we incentivise people using Tata New to use SNBL? On what products can SNBL be applied?
Answer 3	Let's say that a person plans to buy a refrigerator. So he can deposit a certain amount of money every month with Tata Neu, and once the entire amount is deposited after a few months, he can purchase the refrigerator. This is the concept of SNBL. To incentivise people, we can give them rewards, cashbacks, etc. And how Tata Neu can manage to give them these rewards is that it can invest the money deposited by customers and gain returns, and a part of those returns can be shared with the customers in the form of rewards.

Round 2 - Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Tell me about your favourite product? What are the things you would like to improve about it?
Answer 1	Talked about Make My Trip as my favourite product. Listed out reasons why I like the product so much. Then I went on to describe the customer journey and

	what are the current gaps which MMT is not addressing currently. Then I gave solutions that MMT can implement to address those gaps.

Round 3 - Behavioural, Situational [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Why Tata Digital?
Question 2	Who is your role model and why?
Question 3	How would your friends at ISB describe you? Tell me three things that you like about ISB and three things that you don't like

Company: Tata Digital

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - No
3 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Questions from my PM work ex
Answer 1	Explained about my responsibilities and problems I used to solve
Advice	Be thorough with your intro line i.e. Tell me something about yourself. Be ready for follow up questions on that

Round 2 - Behavioural, Situational [30-60 min]	
Question 1	If the developer you are assigned in a project is not meeting delivery timelines due to low bandwidth then what you will do?
Answer 1	Speak to his manager. Understand why there is low bandwidth. Help the developer in prioritisation. Eventually make informal relations with developer so that he goes out of his bounds to work on my project
Question 2	Whats your view on hyperlocal delivery industry (Dunzo, Blinkit, etc)
Answer 2	Told my concern about sustainability. But was cut by the interviewer saying soon Dunzo and Blinkit would switch to EVs

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TVS Motors

Company: TVS Motors

Product Manager: Digital & AI

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
2 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural, Situational, Product Strategy, Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	What are your top 3 favourite apps & why?
Answer 1	Telegram, inshorts & spotify. I described how I personally relate to these applications. Listed top 3-4 features that I resonate with. I described how it solves a unique pain point & how it stands out from the competition.
Question 2	How would you recommend Spotify to your friends?
Answer 2	Identify music/ podcast taste of the friend; curate a Spotify playlist that the friend resonates with. Share the playlist with the friend during their leisure time on a social networking platform that they are most acquainted with.
Question 3	Walk me through one digital/AI application in the automobile industry.
Answer 3	Drowsiness detector & alert system. - Heartbeat detection to detect drowsiness - Computer vision to measure blink rate - Alarm trigger system based on the outputs from the above two processes.
Advice	Understand the job description inside out. Rehearse standard product prep questions thoroughly (product design, strategy, favourite product, rca). Prepare for behavioural questions -why pm? Why TVS? Why AI? What are the transferable skills that you possess?

Company: TVS Motors

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
2 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Situational [0-30 min]	
Question 1	It was a gaming/simulation platform. We were given different situations related to conflict resolution, decision making, etc.
Answer 1	You just have to analyse the situation properly and consider all the stakeholders.

Round 2 - Problem Solving [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Explain the product that you have worked on in the previous organisation and how you would price it.
Answer 1	I explained the product architecture. For pricing, I went for value-based pricing and justified it by telling 5-6 differentiating factors about my product.
Question 2	Explain any technical concept you are familiar with.
Answer 2	I spoke about APIs and their end-to-end flow in very simple terms.

Uber

Company: Uber

Product Manager 1

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
4 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Product Design [0-30 min]	
Question 1	How would you design an app to ease house hunting for a particular area
Answer 1	Followed the product design framework CIRCLES focusing on the Personas pain points and Feature solution

Round 2 - Situational [0-30 min]	
Question 1	How would you evaluate the success of a feature?
Answer 1	Based the answer on data analytics and focused on how data can help with identifying feature usefulness

Round 3 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Basic HR questions
Answer 1	Focused on the Uber values

Walmart

Company: Walmart

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Product Strategy [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Design an app for sports enthusiasts
Answer 1	Spoke about booking football grounds in the city. Focussed on the demand and supply side, their needs and pain points and proposed features and solutions along with priority matrix and success metrics. Divided the solution into MVP and full fledged release product.
Advice	Practice product strategy questions, take maximum time to collaborate with the interviewer and set the problem statement and customer needs. Solution comes second

Round 2 - Go To Market [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Design a smart dustbin and take it to market
Answer 1	Focussed on setting the target market first, followed by some of their needs and pain points related to waste disposal. Included both pressing needs and aspirational requirements. Then followed the product design framework to design the MVP. Defined success metrics. Then emphasised on GTM strategy - marketing+service.
Advice	More than a question-answer, this was a conversation with the interviewer. They will take you out of your framework in no time. This round tested product sense and understanding of how to define market segments and GTM strategies associated with them.

Company: Walmart

Associate Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
2 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Product Design [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Design an app for pet parents
Answer 1	Clarified questions such as what geography, OS, which pet etc. and then started answering using the circles framework. There were multiple interjections and I had to explain why I took certain assumptions such as target personas and why specific pain points. I did mention solutions but was not able to get to the metrics. There was grilling around the solutions as well.
Advice	Be confident with the approach you have practised. Practising different styles of design questions help

Round 2 - Behavioural, Root Cause Analysis [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Questions around resume and the type of role I was into. Interviewer asked about my experience with stakeholder communication.
Answer 1	Explained my role in brief and mentioned that it was client facing. Also mentioned about the onshore-offshore model that we followed and how communication was a key skill required.
Question 2	An OTT app is facing a loss in subscriber base. Figure out the reasons.
Answer 2	Started with clarifying questions and then exploring the internal and external factors. The interviewer was not interested in getting to one specific root cause, rather she wanted to know what important factors I can think of. My answer was about explaining what factors should we consider and why
Advice	Be thorough with the external and internal factors by practising different types of RCA questions. Always focus on the reasoning behind a cause

Winzo

Company: Winzo

Growth and Strategy

General Management
Job Offered - Yes
3 rounds of which 0 were pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Behavioural, Situational, Go To Market [0-30 min]	
Question 1	How should Winzo enter US market
Answer 1	Select target market, legal entity, think of legal and tax implications and routing profits of parent entity, agreements for profit repatriation, risks of competition in US market, promotions
Question 2	What metrics would you use to track success of app launched in 6 months
Answer 2	Number of daily active users, number of users acquired, retention rate
Question 3	What did you like about the app
Advice	Read about the company (business model and challenges), use the app, have ready answers for what you like and improvements, show genuine enthusiasm for the product and keep company specific questions ready to ask at the end of the interview

Round 2 - Behavioural, Go To Market [0-30 min]	
Question 1	What did you like about the app and suggestions
Answer 1	Like: Different arcade games - high choice to user, nudges to use the app, content in regional languages, Suggestions: Build community (they have one on Discord), increase multiplayer games
Question 2	Any latest developments that affect the company's business
Answer 2	Change in GST laws which can lower profits, issues due to gambling laws in India
Advice	The questions might be related to your field of work. My background was law so focus was on public policy along with some get to know candidate questions

Round 3 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	Why Winzo and why we should hire you
Answer 1	Interested in gaming avid gamer, leverage background in law and gaming laws (add your background and how it can help in your role) READ the JD and bring in JD into your behaviour questions
Advice	General founder chat, be good with behaviour questions and push your prior work ex

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Zynga

Company: Zynga

Product Manager

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
4 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Case Discussion [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Case Submission - Increase monetisation of app by 10% aAny app can be chosen - not gaming app specifically, however brownie points for selecting a Zynga app)
Answer 1	I took Zynga app Golf rival
Advice	Be very thorough with your case submission.

Round 2 - Root Cause Analysis [30-60 min]	
Question 1	The revenue of your favourite gaming app is declining. Identify the reason & What metrics you will track
Answer 1	I was asked if I play games. I honestly answered that I am not an avid gamer however I do play some games during free time. I would suggest preparing for at least 2 games (one can be of Zynga) for the interview. Basically understanding the core loop of the game is important. The game which was chosen was Candy Crush and did the detailed RCA. Even if I was not able to reach the exact cause of the problem, the interviewer was pretty impressed with the structure I followed. Also metrics are quite important especially for zynga. I prepared for gaming metrics in a detailed manner and that helped a lot while answering all the questions.
Question 2	Why the gaming industry?
Answer 2	I showed my passion for the industry though not being an avid player myself. I structured my answer around how will I leverage my past experience(understanding consumer behaviour, coming from sales market) in the gaming industry Prepare for metrics(there are certain specific metrics for gaming industry, having an understanding of them is preferrable), Understanding the core loop of the game is very crucial

Round 3 - Behavioural [30-60 min]	
Question 1	It was mostly resume based. I was asked to explain in detail one project I am proud of.
Answer 1	Be thorough with the project and your resume since there are a lot of questions around that project
Question 2	Why Product management and how will I thrive in this industry since I was coming from a very different industry?
Answer 2	I took clues from the pre-placement talk to understand what Zynga is looking for in a candidate. The interviewer seemed convinced with my answers and he especially appreciated me for quoting instances from the pre-placement talk
Advice	Listening the pre-placement talk of the company you are interviewing for helps

Round 4 - Root Cause Analysis [30-60 min]	
Question 1	Downloads of Spotify are decreasing in Europe. Identify the reasons
Answer 1	I divided the solution in 2 parts- content creators and content consumers. Issue was related to content creators. There were no correct answers. He just wanted to see the breadth of my thoughts.

Company: Zynga

Product Manager 1

Product Management
Job Offered - Yes
4 rounds of which 1 was pre-assessment(s)

Round 1 - Guesstimate, Root Cause Analysis, Product Design [60-90 min]	
Question 1	Number of google searches in a day in India.
Answer 1	Started with listing all the users and use cases. Targeted each user, listed the average search done by each user and then aggregated that number to the final google search. Separate users based on age and then list down the number of hours each user group spends on the internet, and I assumed, on average, one google search every 15 mins spent on the internet by each age group. Once I have the number of searches, then to arrive at the population number in each user group, divide them by rural and urban split and then internet penetration in each case. I missed considering the other search engines but I mentioned all my assumptions clearly and kept explaining my steps. The whole process was very engaging, and the interviewer was very supportive and kept asking questions and correcting me.
Question 2	Revenue of Swiggy is dropping by 10%. Find out the reason in the least possible step.
Answer 2	Started with breaking down daily revenue into DAU * ARPDAU, further divided DAU =New Install + Returning Users and ARPDAU = ARPPU * Conversion rate. Once I had this breakup, I picked one lever at a time and carried out my analysis. Breaking down into the structure helped me to know the exact issue to drill down into. For drilling down, I followed the customer journey funnel, and the interviewer was impressed with the structural thinking and stopped me midway without reaching the actual issue.
Advice	Follow common sense and logic while assuming something. Communicate your assumption very clearly. Practice guesstimate and RCA a lot and always follow structure. Just to be exhaustive, do not pour questions over the interviewer; rule out options structurally.

Round 2 - Product Design [60-90 min]	
Question 1	Part-A :- Give 5 reasons why "snakes and ladder" is still an attractive game. Why do people still play this game? Part B :- How will you improve "snakes and ladder" to make it more attractive?
Answer 1	Part - A: I started listing what snakes and ladders offer, 1-Uncertainty, 2 - Thrill, 3 - easy to play, 4- Short duration of finishing one game, so people don't get bored. 5 - Competition with other players Explain how each point keeps a player hooked. Part B: I target one of the above-mentioned points. I said I would increase the thrill in the game by giving users a fighting chance with snakes. At large, the interviewer wanted to see my structural and logical thinking. Games generally work on human psychology; the interviewer wanted to see how I could think in that aspect.
Advice	If you are interested in gaming, read deconstruction for fun just to have that game designer thinking.

Round 3 - Behavioural [0-30 min]	
Question 1	You have no relevant experience of the role or the industry, how will you fit as a PM in Gaming industry,
Answer 1	I submitted a case in the pre assessment round and focused on that. and showed the transferable skills that I acquired from my work.
Question 2	Give an example where you have faced an issue with your deliverable and how you handled it.
Answer 2	I picked 1-2 instances from my work and talked about it.
Advice	no specific preparation is required. Prepare for general behavioural questions.

Extra Interview Experiences

Here are some key companies / roles that did not come for placements for Class of 2023, due to the macroeconomic situation at the time. We hope they hire for your year, and in the case they do, we have collected interview experiences from previous batches for these companies & roles.

Accenture

Company - Accenture

Role - Technology Consultant

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Details of the pre-assessment round - Resume based shortlisting

Number of rounds - 4

Round 1
Question Category - Metrics, Technical

Duration (in mins) - 40

Question 1
As a clothing retail store, what all data points would you want to collect?
Approach for Question 1
Scoping:
Asked details on business context, business objectives, geography, details of merchandise, sales channels, etc Identifying dimensions of data:
Customer, Geography, Product, Time, Sales,
Data Sources:
EPOS, online sales, purchases from suppliers, customer's social media profile

Question 2
Build a dashboard with the collected data for the store manager.
Approach for Question 2
Drew a dashboard on a shared PowerPoint document which contained trends of sales, projections, filters on time & geographies, customer sizes, product hierarchies, etc

Round 2

Question Category - Technical

Duration (in mins) - 40

Question 1
Walk me through the data processing journey in an Azure technology stack. (My resume mentioned prior work experience on Azure)
Approach for Question 1
Walked the interviewer through the technology stack and their respective functions: Azure Data Lake > Azure Data Bricks > Azure Data Factory > SQL Warehouse > PowerBI.

Question 2
Walk me through your past project.

Round 3
Question Category - Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 30

Question 1
What challenges did you face as a Project Manager in your project?

Question 2
How would your juniors describe you as a manager?

Question 3
Why do you want to build a career in the Tech domain?

Round 4
Question Category - Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 30

Question 1
CTC negotiations.

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?
Prior technology consulting, particularly data consulting would help in cracking the interview. For me, a lot of questions were super relevant to my prior job.

Amazon

Company - Amazon

Role - AFBP Program Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Type of Pre-assessment round - Fitment test

Details of the pre-assessment round:
It was a generic fitment psychometric test

Number of rounds - 4

Round 1
Question Category - Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 35

Question 1
All questions were around leadership principles and how I displayed them in my previous work experience.

Approach for Question 1
Follow the STAR method while explaining and always ask before dwelling into any details.
Make sure to mention their 16 leadership principles at every step of the way.
If you find that your interview is tough suddenly out of nowhere, it may be that you're being interviewed by the bar-raiser. Their job is to stress-test you so don't worry.
Just make sure you can show customer empathy and stakeholder management skills, and link this to their leadership principles.

Atlassian

Atlassian interviewed very few people from Co'23, so interview experience is brought from Co'22 for extra information during preparation.

Company - Atlassian

Role - Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Number of rounds - 3

Round 1

Question Category - Product Design, Guesstimate

Duration (in mins) - 50

Question 1

Case solution discussion

Approach for Question 1

I Picked one drive and gave a solution of creating templates from documents within the org. They grilled me on the benefits of the solution and challenges with the solution considering the fact that if Microsoft has templates so will one drive.

Question 2

Guesstimate on flights departing from Delhi airport. Favourite product and what will you improve? Give metrics for the same. What is it that excites you about technology? Where do you see the AR/VR space expanding? **Approach for Question 2**

I have IG as my favourite product and talked about reels, what I like, what I think we can improve based on problems I face.

For technology, I gave an answer linked to how PM's use it and why I will love it.

Round 2

Question Category - Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 40

Question 1

1. What interests you in PM?

2. What was some time when you were criticised?
3. What are a few of your major achievements?
4. What was a time when you got constructive feedback and you worked on it?
5. What was a time when you failed as a team?
6. What was the time when you made a mess at a client site?

Approach for Question 1

All based on personal stories

Round 3

Question Category - Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 30

Question 1

Intro, Values of Atlassian and which one value will you pick?
Did you criticise anyone and were you criticised by anyone?
As a team, give an instance when you failed.
Did you work on any such project that changed in scope?
This was taken by an HR

Approach for Question 1

All based on personal experience. Show some weaknesses and how you improved them because it's important to show acceptance to change and get better.

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?

The experience was very smooth. The HR will update you when each round is cleared and will also ask you for slots. They will tell you what each round will be about so you will have that information. They check for an individual's personality a lot, so focus on HR based questions as well.

Company - Atlassian

Role - Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company? - Yes

Type of Pre-assessment round - Case Submission

Details of the pre-assessment round
Pick one SaaS product of your choice. Suggest one way you would improve this product. Solution should contain: Problem to be solved, how to validate this hypothesis, What Data would you look at, Success Metrics and Mocks

Tips:
1: Try to keep the company's vision and values in mind when you make a case submission. IN this case, given Atlassian's focus on collaboration tools, I picked Microsoft Teams as the product
2: Being very clear about what and why of the problem is critical. Potentially more important than the solution proposed 3: Mockups are not mandatory but show effort - Would strongly recommend

Company - Atlassian

Role - Product Manager

Number of rounds - 3

Round 1

Question Category - Metrics, Technical

Duration (in mins) - 50

Question 1

Questions around the case study: Explain the solution; Pick one metric that you would use to measure success (I had given multiple)

Approach for Question 1

Know your case submission in detail. Specifically, be prepared for questions around Metrics, GTM and pricing- common questions.

Question 2

Suggest one new income stream using for Spotify (no ads, no Premium)

Approach for Question 2

Clarified that the objective was to suggest a new income stream and not simply increase revenues Went ahead with CIRCLES. Segmented basis normal and hardcore fans (both music and podcasts). Prioritised Hardcore as higher WTP

Listed 1 solution around ticketed live events - interviewer agreed but wanted additional solutions. Came up with a music teaching service or an exclusive space for superfans. Prioritised the final one as it's better aligned with business goals.

Tip1: Don't completely rely on frameworks - just use them as guide rails - Interviewers prefer to see framework free thinking these days (doesn't mean unstructured thinking though)

Tip2: List multiple solutions and make sure they address the pain point you came up with. Additionally, business alignment is critical - they expect that from B school students

Question 3

Follow Up Question: How would you price these features?

Approach for Question 3

Followed the usual pricing framework (The Pricing elective is a good prep course for these types of questions) - Cost plus, Competitor and Value based. Since MC = 0, cost plus doesn't apply. Went with competitor which in my case was Patreon

Round 2

Question Category - Metrics, Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 50

Question 1

Round Details: This was the leadership fit round

Q1: How do you prioritise between features - share an example

Approach for Question 1

Basically, they want to understand how you would go about prioritising different tasks

Share a framework that you would use and then give an example - Leverage this for all situational questions. Demonstrates structure

Mentioned that I would first check business goal alignment. Then go ahead with RICE. Finally check if there are some exigencies such as legal or regulatory requirements or resource crunches which might change things. Shared a relevant example from my career.

Question 2

Question around metrics - how I had leveraged them in my career

Question 3

Top tech trends according to you and why

Approach for Question 3

Looked at it from multiple angles - General trends > Web 3 (trust), Metaverse (Collaboration) Shared separate trends from enterprise tech

Leverage your strengths for this type of question and try to connect with the company's values Interviewer Feedback

Interviewer was the GPM at Atlassian - appreciated my candour. Keep in mind that authenticity is important to Atlassian

Round 3

Question Category - Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 45

Question 1

Round Details: This is the values round: Eliminative and completely focused on Atlassian's values. Prep well for this round and keep examples ready

Share an instance when you helped someone in your organisation and your

learnings from this experience

Approach for Question 1

Tips: Be structured and authentic.

Share examples where you observed an issue and volunteered to help as opposed to ones where you were required to as a part of your role

Question 2

Time when you had a disagreement with a co-worker and how you dealt with it

Approach for Question 2

Tip: Share a general approach for how you deal with this type of situation and then share an example where I disagreed with my manager but was able to bring her around to my point of view. I mentioned I took a risk and that my approach failed but I learned from it - This was especially appreciated by the interviewer

Question 3

Share a time when you were engaged in a personal project

Approach for Question 3

Be careful with this question. This question is effectively designed to test whether you are a high agency individual and a doer.

Interviewer Feedback

This was with the Director for University Recruitment at Atlassian. She was appreciative of the examples I had shared during the discussion

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?

Make sure you go through Atlassian's values before you appear for the interviews.

Dream11

Company - Dream11

Role - Senior Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Number of rounds - 3

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design

Duration (in mins) - 25

Question 1
How will you monetise Fantasy Premier League?
Approach for Question 1
Had researched on Play to Earn games and applied the same models to FPL. I was not allowed to follow any framework, they wanted quick ideas based on clear logical reasoning and cross-questioned based on what I explained.
Interviewer Feedback
The interviewer had not played FPL but liked how I explained each solution.

Round 2
Question Category - Product Design

Duration (in mins) - 20

Question 1
How will you increase engagement amongst players during international breaks in football in Fantasy premier league or Dream11?
Approach for Question 1
Answered around increasing social interactions type features in the game to ensure players are hooked on to the platform during these breaks

Round 3
Question Category - Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 25

Question 1

As a PM, will you always go for product led growth?

Question 2

Do you follow the do it right first-time approach or fail fast approach?

Question 3

Which skills do you think you need to become a good PM?

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?

Would be nice to have some perspective on Fantasy sports and the competitors of D11 in this space.

Company - Dream11

Role - Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Number of rounds - 3

Round 1

Question Category - Product Design

Duration (in mins) - 40

Question 1

Build an Influencer Program for Dream11

Approach for Question 1

Followed CIRCLES; Checked in regularly with the interviewers to see if they wanted anything more than what I was stating

Interviewer Feedback

Seemed reasonably happy

Round 2

Question Category - Metrics, GTM/Market Entry, Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 45

Question 1

SaaS start-up wants to enter the Communication & Engagement industry, how can it succeed here?

Approach for Question 1

Understood the state of the industry, realised no firm was really dominant and customers were generally unsatisfied; Went through customer pain points and came up with an offering to solve for those.

Question 2

What do you like most about the Dream11 app?

Question 3

What factors would you consider when prioritising what to build given constrained resources?

Round 3

Question Category - Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 30

Question 1

Why PM? What culture do you like? Conflict example? Failure Example?

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?

Make sure you actually have experience with the app, it is important to them.

Company - Dream11

Role - PM

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Number of rounds - 3

Round 1

Question Category - Product Design, Metrics, GTM/Market Entry

Duration (in mins) - 45

Question 1

How would you solve the problem of ordering from multiple places at once on Swiggy?

Approach for Question 1

Identified which set of users are being affected by this problem and what are the scenarios under which they would use this feature. Listed down potential solutions and pitfalls

Question 2

How would you track the success of this feature?

Approach for Question 2

Divided the metrics into north star, L1, and L2 metrics. Described why is it important to track each one of them

Question 3

How would you release this feature?

Approach for Question 3

Listed down pre-launch and launch activities and included both supply and demand side initiatives. Also added metrics for each activity

Round 2

Question Category - RCA, Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 45

Question 1

Cart abandonment for Myntra has gone up recently. Find out why?

Approach for Question 1

Clarified what we meant by cart abandonment. Listed down external factors but eliminated them with the help of the interviewer. Then mapped the user journey and identified where

exactly the drop offs were happening. Then listed down a set of problems that could lead to an increase in cart abandonment

Question 2

If you ship 2 features at the same time to impact the same metric, how would you measure which one is more successful?

Approach for Question 2

A/B testing

Question 3

The design teams want to ship an extremely elaborate design while the engineering team does not agree, how will you address this issue?

Round 3

Question Category - Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 50

Question 1

Biggest challenge faced, what does product management mean to you, why Dream11, as a PM do you focus more on user experience or revenue

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?

Would have helped if I stayed a bit calmer. I was unable to answer a question and got a little flustered; however, the interviewer guided me back and I was able to solve the problem. be as structured as possible and involve the interviewers

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Epifi (fi.money)

Company - Epifi (fi.money)

Role - Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Type of Pre-assessment round - Case Submission

Details of the pre-assessment round
Assume you are a PM at Google Pay and driving their mobile consumer app. Propose a strategy to ensure Google Pay remains a market leader in its space and redesign the Google Pay homepage with this strategy

Number of rounds - 5

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design

Duration (in mins) - 60

Question 1
Discuss the case solution submitted by you
Approach for Question 1
Prepare in advance and focus on clear decision pointers for the chosen strategy

Question 2
Redesign the homepage for the Netflix Android App
Approach for Question 2
Applied a slightly tweaked version of CIRCLES. Identify and clarify the goal, walk through the user journey and then proceed with CIRCLES. Ask questions wherever required.
Interviewer Feedback
Wireframes submitted for the case were not very thought through from a user perspective.

Round 2
Question Category - Product Design

Duration (in mins) - 60

Question 1

Design a bill payment feature for Epifi

Approach for Question 1

The interviewer was looking for clarity of thought and the ability to think of a comprehensive solution. Clarify the goal (to increase the stickiness of the app), ask clarifying questions to define the scope, and keep the interview interactive. **Interviewer Feedback**

Good approach and the interviewer mentioned that they had fun brainstorming on the solution and exploring out of the box options

Round 3

Question Category - Product Design, RCA, Metrics, GTM/Market Entry, Guesstimate, Technical

Duration (in mins) - 75

Question 1

This was a stress round with the product head. It had all kinds of questions ranging from behavioural, technical, product design, RCA, and metrics.

Approach for Question 1

Keep calm, don't get flustered and think through before you answer

Question 2

You are a digital PM for Ken. What metrics would you use to define the happiness index of a user? **Approach for Question 2**

Define the time period, try to think of all metrics that might be important from a customer perspective, keep the AAARR framework in mind so you do not miss out on any important metric

Question 3

Flipkart is opening its sale promo at 5 pm on its mobile app and expects 10x load than what the servers can handle. Without scaling up or out, how would you handle the traffic?

Approach for Question 3

The interviewer was looking for a smart approach to the solution that I could not arrive at immediately. But the knowledge of technicalities was important.

Interviewer Feedback

The interviewer mentioned that I need help solving tricky questions and will need some improvement in design areas

Round 4

Question Category - Technical

Duration (in mins) - 60

Question 1

Design a Pokémon Go type game and define its architecture

Approach for Question 1

The interviewer was looking for a complete technical solution and drilled down on the specifics of technical architecture. My approach was to break down the problem into smaller bits before proposing solutions. The interviewer asked about the scaling challenges of the game and how I would solve them.

Interviewer Feedback

The interviewer mentioned that although I could approach the problem calmly and come up with a decent solution, I should focus more on learning about scaling an application.

Round 5

Question Category - Product Design, Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 60

Question 1

Design a dynamic traffic light, highlight the Pros and Cons, and arrive at a Go / No Go decision

Question 2

Behavioural questions based on my resume

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?

The interviews were fairly technical and mostly focused on product design. Behavioural questions were asked in almost every round.

Company - Epifi (fi.money)

Role - Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Type of Pre-assessment round - Case Submission

Details of the pre-assessment round
Assume you are a PM at Swiggy and driving their mobile consumer app. Propose a strategy to ensure Swiggy remains a market leader in its space and redesign the Swiggy homepage with this strategy

Number of rounds - 5

Round 1
Question Category - Guesstimate

Duration (in mins) - 60

Question 1
Estimate the ad revenue for Facebook in India
Approach for Question 1
I had worked with performance marketing a bit as a PM, and I believe this was the reason for this particular question. I followed a top-down approach, starting with an estimate of the number of Facebook users, filtering them by active users. Then I estimated session length, sessions/day and ads/session. I did lean on personal experience a little while calculating these numbers, but also checked in with the interviewer regularly. The interviewer was receptive to this and offered helpful course correction. Once I had the number of ads viewed per user per day, I discussed the CTR (Click Through Rates) to be used with the interviewer and calculated revenue based on the CPC (Cost per Click). This was a very conversational round, although the interviewer did make me calculate the guesstimate to the final number. Taking it step by step and checking in with the interviewer was key in this round.

Round 2
Question Category - Product Design

Duration (in mins) - 60

Question 1
do a critique of Google Pay and suggest some improvements to the app

Approach for Question 1

The interviewer encouraged me to open the app on my phone and do a live critique as I browsed the app. While doing this, I did make mental notes on certain aspects that I felt could be up for improvement. However, when the conversation switched to this, I started by first deciding on an objective as well as target user set for whom the improvement was to be done. The interviewer seemed to agree with this approach. I suggested improvements along the lines of group payments, bill payment reminders, as well as de-focusing offers from the home page. My reasoning behind this was to make Google Pay the easiest way to send money and create habit-forming behaviour through seamless UX. The interviewer asked a few counter questions on this, but seemed convinced when I compared this to the UX of Paytm and PhonePe (which I pulled up on my phone). This was a conversational round and was primarily to understand the level of comfort I had with product design.

Round 3

Question Category - Product Design, RCA, Metrics, Behavioural, Technical

Duration (in mins) - 75

Question 1

This round was with one of the Co-founders and was a mix of product sense, RCA and behavioural questions. This round also had elements of a stress interview where the interviewer was constantly dismissive of my answers and also pressured me to answer questions quickly. The first question he gave me was - “You are a PM at The Ken. What metrics will you include in a ‘happiness index’ for your readers?”.

Approach for Question 1

This was a pretty open-ended question, and the interviewer did not offer much clarification except that I needed to list metrics that would give a well-rounded picture of user satisfaction. I started by segmenting the product into its mobile, desktop and newsletter variants and listed L1 metrics for each. Next, I dived deeper into specific low-level metrics. The interviewer kept asking me for more and more metrics, and after naming (and giving the reasoning for 20-25 metrics, I told him I was done. After this, the interviewer gave me another question, this time an RCA -

Question 2

Readership numbers are going down across the Ken product. How would you diagnose this problem? **Approach for Question 2**

This was a rapid-fire style question, and the interviewer asked me to think out loud instead of following a structure.

Question 3

You are a PM at a shopping site. You have to show a special offer video, that is customised

to each of your 100 million users at a specific time (when the offer goes live). However, you only have bandwidth and resources to do this for 30 million users. How would you solve this?

Approach for Question 3

This wasn't an easy question, and all solutions suggesting showing the offer to users asynchronously were dismissed by the interviewer. I suggested some solutions around user-side caching and sharding of the videos, but these didn't do the trick either. In the end, we ran out of time and the round ended.

Round 4

Question Category - Technical

Duration (in mins) - 60

Question 1

This was a purely technical round with the Head of Engineering at Fi. He first went through the engineering culture and we discussed my time as a software engineer. The question I was given in this round was "How would you design the technical architecture for the Pokemon Go game and what are some issues you foresee with the same?"

Approach for Question 1

I started this case by first clarifying and narrowing-down the exact requirements. For this, practising system design questions helped quite a bit. I was asked to begin by first designing the coordinate system to be used in the game. Here, the interviewer asked multiple questions from low-level design (Int v/s Floating) to high level questions such as DB design (SQL v/s NoSQL). Once this was done, I was asked to design a simple API for the app, which would allow a user to view and update their caught Pokemon. Here too, the interviewer cross-checked by asking me to type the request/response JSON in the chat window. When asked to mention the issues I could foresee with my solution, I mentioned scalability and reliability. The interviewer asked me to suggest some solutions for scalability and I offered Caching and refinements to the Search algo. The round ended with a few brain teaser puzzles (e.g divide a triangle into 3 equal parts).

Round 5

Question Category - Product Design, Behavioural, Fitment

Duration (in mins) - 30

Question 1

This was a short cultural fitment round with another co-founder from Fi. The interviewer asked me personal questions as well as my aspirations. I was also asked multiple

behavioural questions around my career as a PM (challenges, wins etc).

Question 2

This round had elements of a stress interview as well since the interviewer did not allow me to think before answering and wanted to do a ‘rapid-fire’ style of interview.

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?

Be very well prepared on boilerplate questions for stress rounds. The interviewer can and will not give you time to think and even make notes. Practice is key!

Flipkart

Company - Flipkart

Role - PM-1

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Type of Pre-assessment round - Case Submission

Details of the pre-assessment round
Tell us about a real-world problem that you have observed around you which can be solved using a digital product

Number of rounds - 3

Round 1
Question Category - RCA

Duration (in mins) - 30

Question 1
Asked me an RCA question related to my case submission. We implemented feature X and saw great adoption in the first 3 months. However, engagement has gone in the past 2 weeks. Think of reasons why.
Approach for Question 1
Clarified what engagement meant exactly. Listed external factors first but eliminated them based on some general knowledge. Then listed potential issues with the feature as well as the app. Did not get a definite yes or no on any parameter, so listed down metrics that would help me identify the problem. Got a response there. Used the interviewer's response to narrow down the problem

Question 2
Possible solutions and north star metric to overcome this problem
Approach for Question 2
Listed top 3 solutions that would help with the problem and then shortlisted the most feasible one. I chose a north star accordingly. Also added potential pitfalls - both from a product and business side

Round 2
Question Category - Product Design, Metrics

Duration (in mins) - 60

Question 1

Top 3 metrics for Instagram Live

Approach for Question 1

Started with stating why IG Live was introduced and what was the main problem it was solving. Then identified two users - creators & viewers. Listed down top 3 metrics each.

Question 2

How would you increase the number of paid users for Spotify in India?

Approach for Question 2

Started with what was the main goal and clarified the current offerings. Then segmented the users and identified what issues they face. While it sounds like a product design question, the interviewer wanted a more strategic answer. So, I listed down potential growth strategies such as bundling, tiered pricing, etc.

Question 3

Favourite product and how would you improve it?

Approach for Question 3

Chose GPay as my favourite product. Explained its business strategy and listed down reasons why I prefer using it over any other digital payment app. For improvement - clarified which user am I exactly solving for. The interviewer said I can assume I have to improve it for me i.e., the end user. Listed down 3 new features which would improve GPay for me

<u>Round 3</u>

Question Category - Technical, Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 45

Question 1

General questions around why I decided to join ISB, what did I learn here, why Flipkart, challenges I might face at Flipkart, problems I faced with the engineering team at my last job and how did I solve it

Question 2

What did the system architecture look like for a feature I shipped at my last job?

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?

Try and make it as conversational as possible. All my interviewers were super calm and did not give away a lot, but they did guide me whenever I needed help.

Company - Flipkart

Role - PM-1

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Type of Pre-assessment round - Case Submission

Details of the pre-assessment round
Tell us about a real-world problem that you have observed around you which can be solved using a digital product

Number of rounds - 3

Round 1
Question Category - Case submission based

Duration (in mins) - 50

Question 1
The interviewer asked me a number of questions while evaluating the submission I had for the screening round case.
Approach for Question 1
This round was a combination of deep dives into my work experience as well as the case submission I had done. The interviewer was interested in my work as a PM, since I had worked on products that were similar to his team's. This part wasn't particularly technical, but I was asked to justify the metrics I had mentioned. I was ready for this from my prep, so this wasn't very difficult to do. Next, the interviewer was very interested in the solution I had submitted in the case study round. The interviewer went slide-by-slide and asked me specific details, and implementation plans for almost everything I had mentioned in the submission. This was slightly difficult due to the detailed questions asked. The interviewer also asked me my reasoning for the prioritisation I had chosen, as well as the GTM strategy for my solution. The round ended with a discussion on the metrics (particularly the North Star) that I had chosen.

Round 2
Question Category - Product Design, Metrics

Duration (in mins) - 60

Question 1

How would you improve the Facebook experience for dating?

Approach for Question 1

This was similar to product improvement questions I had practised, and hence the approach was very clear. However, the question was pretty ambiguous and I had to ask many questions (5-7) to narrow it down to an acceptable problem statement. The interviewer narrowed the problem down to the blue app, and the objective of increasing retention. I followed the standard approach from the BTC handbook and chose to focus on the 18-30 age segment, and suggested solutions that leveraged Facebook's emulation of read-world networks to make the online dating experience safer. The interviewer initially seemed sceptical of my approach, but I believe I was able to convince him after 2-3 rounds of back-and-forth discussion. Next we had a conversation on the success metrics and risks for the features I had suggested. The round ended with a 'rapid fire' of 3-4 questions where the interviewer asked me to select North Star metrics for some products (e.g. Insta Live, Spotify Premium etc.)

Round 3

Question Category - Guesstimate, Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 45

Question 1

Estimate the number of tube lights in Delhi

Approach for Question 1

Here, the interviewer wanted me to come up with the final number as well as explain my approach. I had practised similar questions during my prep, and I think taking constant feedback, as well as asking good clarifying questions before you start is essential. Also, the approach you follow matters much more than the actual number you come up with, so make an effort to explain yourself well.

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?

For any consumer product/company, be very well versed in their current offering. For me, familiarity with Flipkart's rewards programme was a huge conversation point in the interview.

Google

Company - Google

Role - Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - No

Number of rounds - 7

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design

Duration (in mins) - 45

Question 1
How would you design the restaurant search experience on Google in the Covid era?
Approach for Question 1
Defined the mission and goal before starting with the CIRCLE framework. Defined covid pain points and then described solutions using the CIRCLEs framework. Prioritised using Impact/Effort framework.

Round 2
Question Category - RCA, Metrics, GTM/Market Entry

Duration (in mins) - 45

Question 1
Analytics Round
1. Define the key metrics for Gmail mobile app.
RCA question on 5% dip in Daily Active Users on the Gmail app
3. Guesstimate question on # of flights taking off every hour in India
Approach for Question 1
1. Used AAARR framework for defining the key metrics using Gmail app.

Question 2
RCA question on 5% dip in Daily Active Users on the Gmail app
Approach for Question 2
Defined external and internal factors for the possible reasons for the dip in daily active users (%).

Question 3

Guesstimate question on # of flights taking off every hour in India

Approach for Question 3

of airports X average # of runway strips post runway X operational hours % X fulfilment capacity X average TAT for take-off

Round 3

Question 1

How would you redesign the college dorm laundry experience.

Round 4

Question Category - Product Strategy

Duration (in mins) - 45

Question 1

Should Google get into the e-learning business?

Approach for Question 1

1. Clarifying questions
2. Mission of Google
3. Defined goals
4. Strengths/Weaknesses of Google
5. Porter's 5 forces
6. Risks and mitigations
7. Product Strategy

Question 2

Imagine you have invented magical boots that help the average person run as fast as Usain Bolt. What would you do next?

Approach for Question 2

1. Clarifying questions
2. Defined goals - revenue, mass adoption, etc.
3. Porter's 5 forces
4. Defined solutions

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?

A long but extremely intensive process involving 6-7 rounds for the final candidates. Learned a lot through the process. You will thoroughly enjoy the interview process regardless of the outcome.

GSN Games

Company - GSN Games

Role - Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Number of rounds - 4

Round 1
Question Category - RCA, Metrics

Duration (in mins) - 35

Question 1
You are the PM for Ludo, there is a sudden dip in the number of users, find out why.
Approach for Question 1
Started off with understanding what do we mean by users first and then how do we define the dip. Then explored internal factors and then external factors to arrive at a conclusion.

Question 2
What metrics would you measure if you were the PM of ludo
Approach for Question 2
Used the AARRR framework for this

Interviewer Feedback
The interviewer liked my approach. I kept it as conversational as possible.

Round 2
Question Category - Product Design, RCA

Duration (in mins) - 45

Question 1
You are the PM at Ludo. There is a sudden drop in the number of chips bought by the users. Find why **Approach for Question 1**
Understood the user base and what we mean by dip. Explored internal factors and then external factors to find the reason

Question 2

How would you position the chips so that users bought it more

Approach for Question 2

First listed where the chips are currently available. Then pinpointed places where users might want chips and where they do not get it. Provided solutions accordingly.

Question 3

Design a game for women belonging to your mother's generation

Approach for Question 3

CIRCLES

Interviewer Feedback

Interviewer really liked the show of empathy in all my answers and the approach taken for each

Round 3

Question Category - Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 20

Question 1

Why Product Management

Question 2

Why the gaming industry

Question 3

why GSN games

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?

Gaming knowledge is not required for the interviews. Be frank of how involved you are with games and questions will be asked accordingly.

Meesho

Company - Meesho

Role - Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Type of Pre-assessment round - Case Submission

Details of the pre-assessment round
Conceptualising a product strategy to improve engagement and retention for end customers on the app

Number of rounds - 1

Round 1
Question Category - RCA

Duration (in mins) - 45

Question 1
You are the PM at LinkedIn. The DAU has dropped. Please find the reason and resolve.

Company - Meesho

Role - Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Number of rounds - 2

Round 1

Question Category - Product Design

Duration (in mins) - 40

Question 1

Flipkart is launching a new ecommerce app focused on Tier 2/3 cities and on new e-commerce users. Think about the User Journey of such a user and take me through the major components you would need in the app

Approach for Question 1

Clarified assumptions - Ecommerce app for Tier 2/3 users who have never shopped online before. Clarified about language - mentioned vernacular only (we took Hindi for the purposes of this case)

The focus was on explaining how the home page would look like. Divided the page into 4 parts - Search bar, Major Categories, Deals of the Day and the Add to cart button.

The interviewer then proceeded to ask how each of these 4 parts will be designed - Focus was on understanding if I could empathize with the pain points of the customer that I didn't know very well and if I could come up with some quick solutions on the go.

My answer focused heavily on using pictorial representation to help users understand concepts which would not necessarily be intuitive to them

Question 2

Follow up questions on

Specifics around how you would go about designing the search, what would be the phrasing for Add to Cart, how would you represent ratings for users who are not comfortable with English and how would you measure success how you would represent address

Approach for Question 2

For Add to Cart - We arrived on a version of Bag me daale or Thaile me Daale

For Address - Save as a voice note for ease of use

Tip: Work with the interviewer and take them through your thought process. Most the times, they would love to help

Round 2

Question Category - Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 25

Question 1

This was more of a culture fit/managerial round
Questions focused on past experiences, why PM and why would I be a good fit for a PM role. One interesting question was: Pitch to me that you are an ambitious person

Approach for Question 1

Read about Meesho's culture and values on the internet and try to craft your answers around that. Have stories and relevant examples for everything you share and most importantly, show structure even in the cultural rounds

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?

This was a slightly different process compared to the others. Since the Pre-Assessment round covered Product Strategy and design, there wasn't a strong focus on Product Design questions in the interview. Instead, it was completely focused on empathising with the user.

Microsoft

Microsoft did not hire many students from Co'23. Since Microsoft is a target company for many, and it comes for placements regularly, we are also including previous batches' interview experience, in the hopes that it will help in your preparation.

Company - Microsoft

Role - Program Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Number of rounds - 3

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design

Duration (in mins) - 50

Question 1
Discuss your favourite product. Suggest an improvement on your favourite product to achieve user growth.
Approach for Question 1
Picked up Spotify as my favourite product. Applied basic CIRCLES logic and identified the use case of playing music collaboratively at a party.

Round 2
Question Category - Product Design

Duration (in mins) - 50

Question 1
Design a search engine for enterprise users
Approach for Question 1
Interviewer cross-questioned a lot on technical constraints. How would you parse different files together, how can different enterprise systems be integrated, what all technical constraints do you foresee? Applied CIRCLES but the remaining discussion was prompted by interviewer's discussion

Round 3
Question Category - Product Design

Duration (in mins) - 50

Question 1

Microsoft has a lot of data on users' likes and dislikes, their contacts and daily schedules. Using this data and AI technology, design a product

Approach for Question 1

CIRCLES won't work here. The interviewer wanted a backwards approach, designing a product with technology in mind. Had to identify use cases where such data would be useful, defining "increasing productivity of a corporate employee" as the objective. The interviewer helped in deciding on the use case.

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?

Interviewers are very helpful, just listen to their counter arguments patiently and you'll be able to arrive at the answer

Company - Microsoft

Role - PM

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Type of Pre-assessment round - Live Case

Details of the pre-assessment round
103 shortlisted candidates were split into batches of 2. Common Teams link for each batch where we were briefed about the case question. 10 minutes for asking clarifying questions. Post that had to join an individual Teams link where I kept my camera, and mic on. Shared screen where I was writing the case solution. 25 minutes to solve it. Interviewer popped in once to ask if I had any questions. Emailed the solution within the time frame.

Question given was - 1. Design a travel platform for Microsoft given the status of the pandemic

Post that the interviewer came for a 15–20-minute chat about my solution. (Follow up – which existing products of Microsoft can you leverage, how, why and why not)

Number of rounds - 3

<u>Round 1</u>
Question Category - Product Design, Technical

Duration (in mins) - 60

Question 1
How would you as a PM go about this idea of a travel platform – who will you approach in what order, what information will you need to get them onboard, what dependencies will you think about, how will you get your engineers onboard in the middle of the year, etc. Roleplay where he was playing a reluctant development lead and I was a new PM.
Approach for Question 1
Know what a PM does, the number of teams they have to work with, how consensus is built without authority whatsoever, creating win-wins with reluctant players - essentially was a check to know my understanding of what a PM does and how I would react in situations when I have to get various teams on board for a plan without being their leader.

Question 2
Every project/task I worked on as a developer at Rakuten was discussed in varying depths, some questions related to the tech/languages/software that I had listed on my

resume (all resume based)

Approach for Question 2

Resume should be known thoroughly. Be comfortable with each task, project, number and timeline that you've written. Don't faff on your resume, interviewers are experts - it's not very difficult to catch far-fetched numbers. And questioning can sometimes go deep enough to identify whether or not one has really worked on the task.

Question 3

One of the projects was closely related to something the interviewer had expertise in. So, we spent around 20 minutes discussing the details.

Approach for Question 3

Again, resume based. Lots of comparisons in working style and development models used at Microsoft vs Rakuten.

Round 2

Question Category - Product Design, Technical

Duration (in mins) - ~70

Question 1

How would you deal with fake reviews on Amazon?

Approach for Question 1

1. Ask questions to understand the question thoroughly
2. What are fake reviews => how to ID them
3. Intentions of fake reviewers
4. Impact of these fake reviews? Is the problem worth solving?
5. Actions to take to remove these and prevent them further
6. List a few solutions, prioritize the one to take up based on impact, ease of implementation etc.

Question 2

How would you sort numbers?

Approach for Question 2

Went with Bubble sort. Interviewer was not satisfied with just 1 sorting algorithm, so I went through 2 more and then had to compare contrast complexities between them as well – Bubble Sort, Tree Sort, Insertion Sort and just touched upon Quick Sort.

Question 3

Design a platform for working professionals for learning to play musical instruments (additionally was asked to draw wireframes)

Approach for Question 3

Standard approach for design questions. It won't be smooth, lots of new requirements, changes in question would be given to throw you off your course.

Round 3

Question Category - Product Design, Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - ~75

Question 1

Design a browsing experience for offline users.

Approach for Question 1

Conversation also digressed into file storage. It was more like a brainstorming session to know how well I could carve out the segment we would build this product for, why/why not, understand user requirements, and balance it with what's possible in specific circumstances.

Question 2

Loads of questions about work experience again, why the transition from Rakuten to Teach For India. Why Product? What about Microsoft fits in your plan? What sector would you want to work in if given a choice?

Approach for Question 2

Had my own reasons for each transition on my resume very clearly. I knew how and why product management fit in my plan. Was honest about what sector I would work in if given a choice irrespective of whether it was the 'right' answer to give.

Question 3

What are you reading these days? What are you keeping up with in the news? (specifically, tech-related) **Approach for Question 3**

No specific approach. Just a free-flowing conversation.

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?

Keep the interviews conversational, don't make it a monologue. All interviewers were industry experts, so don't lie to them about your work, don't try too hard to impress them. They are very easy to speak to and were happy to guide me when I didn't know how to proceed or was not sure of a particular step I was taking in reaching a solution. Think out loud as much as possible.

Company - Microsoft

Role - PM

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Type of Pre-assessment round - Live Case

Details of the pre-assessment round
Microsoft's screening round after resume shortlisting was a live case, where we were given 30 minutes to solve a problem. This was followed by a 10-12 minute one-on-one discussion with a PM from Microsoft. This round eliminated around 50% of candidates.

Number of rounds - 3

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design, Technical

Duration (in mins) - 90

Question 1
Design a general-purpose monitoring service for a web application

Approach for Question 1
This was an open-ended question, and initially stumped me as I was asked to design a service, and not a product. Because of this, I was unable to apply any of the typical design frameworks I had prepared.
I approached the problem from first principles thinking, and started by drawing a schema for a typical web application, showing the front-end, back-end, database etc. I discussed this with the interviewer to get a sense-check for anything I may have missed. Throughout the case, the interviewer was helpful and nudged me in the right direction. Next, I started listing the metrics from each component of the system that the service should capture. Here, I was grilled a bit and the interviewer made sure I was as exhaustive as possible while listing out the metrics. From here I moved to solutioning and prioritisation. The interviewer chose to deep-dive into the alerting aspect of the monitoring service, and asked lots of counter-questions. Once the interviewer was satisfied with the solutioning, he asked me to sketch wireframes for a dashboard consuming data from the service. The last part of the case was an overview of the GTM that would be followed to sell this service. Here I opted to go with a standard SaaS GTM, using a combination of freemium, pricing tiers and bottom-up marketing.

Round 2

Question Category - Product Design, Technical

Duration (in mins) - ~70

Question 1

Microsoft wants to fuel 10x growth for MS Teams for consumers (as opposed to the B2B market). As a PM at Teams, how would you approach the problem?

Approach for Question 1

After asking a few clarifying questions to narrow down the scope of the problem, I approached this problem keeping both the design and strategy angles in-mind. I spent around 20-25 minutes going over the specifics of the problem and user segment with the interviewer. I chose to spend the maximum amount of time ensuring that the user segments I had identified made sense and were exhaustive. This seemed to do the trick, and the interviewer was much more receptive going forward. After demographic and behavioural segmentation, I was able to settle on Internet-based interest/hobby groups as the target segment. The interviewer grilled me a little on this choice. which I feel I was able to defend well. My reasoning was a mix of competitive analysis as well as the use of network effects and group dynamics to accelerate growth.

The interviewer asked me to skip the solutioning/feature part and directly moved on to success metrics. I suggested keeping new user signups as the north star, with a mix of engagement and retention parameters as L1 metrics.

Round 3

Question Category - Product Design, Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - ~75

Question 1

You are a PM for the MS Office team at Microsoft. Suppose you are given access to a graph of usage data across all MS products. How would you use this tool to improve the user experience across Office products?

Approach for Question 1

After asking a few clarifying questions to narrow down the scope of the problem, I approached this problem keeping both the design and strategy angles in-mind. I spent around 20-25 minutes going over the specifics of the problem and user segment with the interviewer. I chose to spend the maximum amount of time ensuring that the user segments I had identified made sense and were exhaustive. This seemed to do the trick, and the interviewer was much more receptive going forward. After demographic and behavioural segmentation, I was able to settle on Internet-based interest/hobby groups as the target

segment. The interviewer grilled me a little on this choice. which I feel I was able to defend well. My reasoning was a mix of competitive analysis as well as the use of network effects and group dynamics to accelerate growth.
The interviewer asked me to skip the solutioning/feature part and directly moved on to success metrics. I suggested keeping new user signups as the north star, with a mix of engagement and retention parameters as L1 metrics. Standard approach for design questions. It won't be smooth, lots of new requirements, changes in question would be given to throw you off your course.

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?
Microsoft interviews are generally taken by experienced product managers.
Remember to keep the conversation flowing, and try to keep the faff to a minimum, as it will be explicitly called out.

Myntra

Company - Myntra

Role - Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Number of rounds - 4

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design

Duration (in mins) - 50

Question 1
Improve Google Maps

Round 2
Question Category - Technical, Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 50

Question 1
Focus on past work ex and situational questions such as 100 requirements, only bandwidth for 30, how will you prioritise, how you would handle a project running late, how you would estimate the timelines etc

Question 2
Asked to give various modules that would be involved in Swiggy

Round 3
Question Category - Metrics, Guesstimate

Duration (in mins) - 45

Question 1
How to set a threshold value for orders below which delivery charge will be done for

Myntra?

Approach for Question 1
Confirmed actual price level was not important, needed to give logic for coming to a price level

Question 2
What metrics will you use to compare one threshold value against another?

Round 4
Question Category - Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 40

Question 1
HR round with behavioural and situational questions.

Company - Myntra

Role - Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - No

Number of rounds - 4

Round 1

Question Category - Product Design, Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 35

Question 1

Tell me about yourself and follow up.

Question 2

You are the PM at FB, design a feature for old people.

Round 2

Question Category - Guesstimate, Product Design, Technical

Duration (in mins) - 35

Question 1

Find the area of the parking lot of an international airport, for example Delhi Airport.

Approach for Question 1

I solved it by using the number of planes, capacity of each plane versus peak, med, low times of the day. As a follow up question, he asked me what's another way of solving this problem, and I told him through gate capacity and flow rate.

Question 2

Tell me an app you use the most and how would you explain its functionality to the engineering team

Approach for Question 2

Chose WhatsApp and did a stepwise breakdown of each feature on the app.

Round 3

Question Category - Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 45

Question 1

Leadership round, tell me something about yourself which isn't on your CV.

Question 2

How would you handle difficult situations and high-level stakeholders at work?

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?

Smooth process, try to converse with the interviewer.

OLX

Company - OLX

Role - Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Number of rounds - 3

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design, GTM/Market Entry

Duration (in mins) - 45

Question 1
You are the CEO of an insurance company. You have seen a sudden surge in the number of claims. How will you take a decision whether to continue this business or not?
Approach for Question 1
I started by breaking down the problem more with the following questions: 1. What % increase have we witnessed 2. Which type of insurance 3. Which month are we talking about? The whole idea was if the claim size went above the company's revenue, then it's a loss-making business for me. The person mentioned that it's for car and bike business. Then started with the possible reasons for the surge such as: Year-end sales for second hand cars etc 2. Covid impact 3. New launches in Jan which might have led to people doing claims to increase their car's resale value. The interviewer was happy with the breakdown and did not sway much from the flow. He was quite supportive in guiding throughout the process.

Question 2
Design a product for the blue collar workforce.
Approach for Question 2
This was a fairly long and open-ended questions. Started by defining the business goal. What kind of business is required in the current scenario? After deliberating, zeroed on to a virtual training platform. The question also came for a B2C vs a B2B business. I chose B2C as it was a new business and convincing the businesses initially would be tough task. Talked about the categories for which training would be provided and why such as electrician, plumber etc. Picked one category and then what all things would be there in the training such a progress report, continuous evaluation, placement opportunities etc. Then the standard GTM part. As a bonus point, I also talked about the B2B side of the business if I were to choose it

Question 3
HR Round on why OLX, what do you bring to the table etc.
Approach for Question 3

Nothing much, at this point it was already decided whether they want the candidate or not.

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?
The process was fairly simple, and the interviewers were also quite helpful during the interview. Just keep an open mind and don't just go by the framework mentioned. This could help you stand out if you're thinking is very practical and raw.

Company - OLX

Role - APM

Did you get an offer from the company - No

Number of rounds - 1

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design, GTM/Market Entry

Duration (in mins) - 30

Question 1
Which is your favourite product and why?

Question 2
Should Netflix enter the personal video uploads market?

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?
They asked general product questions that you'd prepare during your product prep. I'd suggest go through their existing products and think about any improvements that you'd like to do

Company - OLX

Role - Associate Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Number of rounds - 3

Round 1
Question Category - RCA

Duration (in mins) - 20

Question 1
Flipkart has faced a drop of 30% in the sales of its electronics category in the last month. What would you do as the product manager?
Approach for Question 1
I asked some clarifying questions like changes in the UI, sales being run by other big platforms, etc. But the interviewer was more interested in a practical answer rather than a framework based one. The he himself directed me to the answer that as a product manager I will quickly run a check on which stage of the customer journey has the traffic really dropped and once that stage is caught then deep dive into the solution for it.

Round 2
Question Category - Product Design, Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 25

Question 1
What design changes can be made to increase the attachment rate of add-on services like warranty to the products?
Approach for Question 1
1. By default addition
2. Partnerships with banks for offers
3. Video on the product page explaining the loss if add-on not taken

Question 2
Why Product management?
Approach for Question 2
Talked about a start-up experience which made me realise the gap in my understanding about how important product in any business is. Additionally, product management is a perfect amalgamation of technology and business ideas, which is a great add-on.

Question 3

You have only applied to product roles, are you not scared that you have not diversified?

Approach for Question 3

There's absolutely no fear, ISB has made me self-assured. Things will fall in place; I don't want to compromise on what I want.

Interviewer Feedback

Honesty is exactly what made the interview a hit.

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?

Don't stick to the frameworks, be practical and honest.

Company - OLX

Role - Associate Product manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Number of rounds - 3

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design, GTM/Market Entry, Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 60

Question 1
Since I had my own start-up pre ISB, he started by asking me about my start-up.
Approach for Question 1
I moulded my approach to highlight all the product management aspects and things I did in my start-up

Question 2
Ideate your start-up.
Approach for Question 2
From what I understood, he wanted me to ideate my start-up from a product management perspective. It was basically a design question where the question statement was my start-up instead of some hypothetical situation.
I followed the standard design framework, however I had to assume all the clarifying questions myself, including the platform and city.
I went on to find customer segments, prioritise one and then list out the solutions

Question 3
How did your start-up solve customer problems? Highlight only the PM aspects
Approach for Question 3
Since my start-up was a hyperlocal services start-up, a component of solving customer problems was offline. However, he was not interested in the offline aspect, rather just the tech part. He grilled me on various metrics I used to measure, how the platform was solving customer problems, and what the feedback loop was.
A lot of cross questions followed up, wherein he tried to lead me. I felt he was trying to understand if I had done some real stuff or was it all just faff.
My advice would be to get your story sorted. Anticipate all the cross questions beforehand and form them with respect to the role you are applying to.

Round 2
Question Category - RCA

Duration (in mins) - 45

Question 1

Conversion rates are dropping in an E-commerce site.

Approach for Question 1

Even though it was a typical RCA question, contrary to what we practise, I wasn't given any cues for my questions. It was more of a monologue from my side. The major thing he was testing was the breadth of problems that I can identify to solve the issue.

He was quite focused on the metrics I would track, and the multiple issues I could identify.

My advice is to look into the bigger picture. As PMs, we tend to narrow ourselves to just the tech issues, but conversion rates can drop due to business (vendor issues), operational (logistics, supply chain) issues too. I generally break the major issues into 3 buckets: tech, business and operational and then create separate trees for all of them

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?

They are looking for people who are comfortable with coding. I was asked repeatedly if I was comfortable looking at codes and talking to developers. If you are a non-coder, I would recommend brush up on basic coding skills if you want to sound confident in these questions.

Also, get your pre-ISB story straight. You will be grilled on this if it really stands out from the crowd (maybe some start- up, or an extraordinary project).

OLX took majorly non faff interviews, they did not care much about behavioural aspects, they wanted specific profiles and tested candidates on it.

Company - OLX

Role - Senior Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Number of rounds - 4

Round 1
Question Category Product Design, Metrics

Duration (in mins) - 10

Question 1
How would you improve your favourite product (Spotify)? What metrics would you use to evaluate the success of any new features?

Round 2
Question Category - GTM/Market Entry, Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 15

Question 1
How would you fit into an individual contributor role after having been a team leader for 7+ years?

Question 2
Tell us about your experience building apps for an automobile insurer.

Round 3
Question Category - GTM/Market Entry, Technical, Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 20

Question 1
Questions related to past experience in the automobile insurance sector and learnings from dealing with dealerships, workshops, etc.

Question 2
How can OLX improve its service in India and how can you contribute to that?

Oyo

Company - Oyo

Role - Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Number of rounds - 1

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design, Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 45

Question 1
Thorough discussion of previous work experience and resume, reason for switching to OYO and PM role.
Approach for Question 1
Be honest and know your CV well

Question 2
Assuming you're the PM for the OYO app where you want to increase the revenue of the platform via off-platform/ on phone screen pop-ups, how would you go about it? Also ideate the content for these pop-ups.
Approach for Question 2
Enquired whether this is for users who haven't used the app much/dropped off after the first use or for high use customers. Started with creating 3 user personas, prioritized one justifying how it would relate well with the north star metrics (revenue), stated their user journey and the pain points at every journey and ideated content on these pain points. Mentioned metrics to be tracked based on drop-out rates at every point of the journey.

Question 3
Loyalty program for Amazon Prime
Approach for Question 3
Asked if the entire ecosystem of Amazon is to be considered or only the video content. Created profiles pertaining to its various ecosystems- prime video, shopping, Kindle and others. Noted a need of every customer type and tried providing bundling solutions across the channels via exclusivity.

PhonePe

Company - PhonePe

Role - APM

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Type of Pre-assessment round - Case Submission

Details of the pre-assessment round
Imagine you are the PM for a large, on-demand food ordering and delivery platform in India. It's the day after a major holiday which has historically driven your order volumes through the roof. You look at your metrics and see a 35% drop in overall orders for the holiday:
1. Problem: What are the factors that would influence the overall orders. What could be the reasons for the drop and how would you stack rank these
reasons?
2. Metrics: What metrics other than the total orders would you look at to assess the problem statement and investigate the drop and why?

Number of rounds - 2

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design, GTM/Market Entry

Duration (in mins) - 35

Question 1
You are the PM at Gmail. Strategize a 1-year roadmap that Gmail should follow?
Approach for Question 1
I first asked about the goal. We decided that we will focus upon customer acquisition as the primary goal. I started with first identifying the market size, growth goal, and focussed on the competition. Then I asked if we need to focus on building a new feature or focus on an existing solution set. He mentioned a new feature will work. Then I divided the roadmap into 4 quarters. First quarter was devoted to the tech debt and finding the must-have feature for the user base we are targeting. Second and third quarters were focussed on Beta launch and solution validation, with a full launch in the last quarter.
He asked more cross questions in terms of resources, financials etc.

Question 2
Tell me about one project you did as a PM?

Approach for Question 2
I had past PM experience and explained full details of the EdTech app I managed.

Round 2
Question Category - Metrics, Technical, Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 40

Question 1
Tell me about yourself?

Question 2
Explain the project you did? Why did you do it? What were the key metrics you tracked and how did you track them?
Approach for Question 2
Interviewer went into lot of details on the metrics, made me explain the product page-by-page and asked me questions around what metrics you were capturing and how you ensured engagement and retention

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?
PhonePe's process was very simple and well managed. The case study was open ended, and they focussed on the approach rather than the exact solution.

Company - PhonePe

Role - APM

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Type of Pre-assessment round - Case Submission

Details of the pre-assessment round
RCA type case study on - "As a PM, how would you find the issue if you see a drop in no of orders on a grocery app"

Number of rounds - 2

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design

Duration (in mins) - 45

Question 1
How will you increase revenue from transactions from the merchant's side (Swiggy types) as PhonePe's payment gateway?

Question 2
How will you improve google maps? Both engagement and monetisation

Round 2
Question Category - Metrics

Duration (in mins) - 35

Question 1
What would be the key metrics for Swiggy?

Question 2
How will you improve engagement metrics for Swiggy?

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?
Most of the conversation was around each and every step of the answer. It is important to explain why you are saying what you are saying. I was able to apply frameworks in some answers but had to improvise the basis of the requirements. Company did not expect us to have any fintech knowledge. They assessed product thinking only.

Company - PhonePe

Role - Associate Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Number of rounds - 2

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design, Metrics

Duration (in mins) - 30

Question 1
Explain the case submission during pre-assessment
Approach for Question 1
Spoke about the approach in detail. Used the framework in RCA and discussed every branch.

Question 2
Understanding of the mentioned metrics and the insights that can be drawn.
Approach for Question 2
Talk about why you have chosen a particular metrics and how these metrics can act as pseudo signals for any scenario. *Ex:* larger ETAs on Swiggy could be due to lack of delivery executives due to them switching to Zomato for delivery which means Zomato is outperforming Swiggy.

Round 2
Question Category - Product Design, Technical

Duration (in mins) - 45

Question 1
Design a loyalty program for PhonePe merchant platform.
Approach for Question 1
Used CIRCLES, identify the needs and the business case, brainstorm ideas and prioritise.

Question 2
Design the architecture for the above solution.
Approach for Question 2
Basic workflow of how systems will talk to each other and the flow of information between systems. Additional questions on query frequency and load of processing were asked.

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?
Case submission was the most critical part. Round 1 entirely depends on how thoroughly you have worked on the case.

Providence

Company - Providence

Role - Program manager (Product manager)

Did you get an offer from the company - No

Number of rounds - 3

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design, Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 50

Question 1
Basic intro.
Approach for Question 1
Include as much detail as possible including why healthcare and why Providence. I took over 5 minutes to answer this

Question 2
Questions around Project and Program management - special focus on risk management.
Approach for Question 2
What if schedule slippage, how would you translate business vision into a charter, what if the CXO's priority changes midway, How would you prioritise between 2 projects and how would you convince the business, How did you incorporate risk management in your projects, how did you quantify risk- Drew on work experience and answered these

Question 3
Design a cyber security plan for Providence and how do you convey the ROI of a cyber security project.
Approach for Question 3
For security plan- Asked clarifying questions around constraints like HIPAA and org related constraints, data usage within the org.
Answer- Suggested a cloud-based approach 1. Identity and Access management (for both patient data as well as general access management of people) 2. Current systems Threat assessment and correction 3. Creation of mitigation/recovery plans

Round 2
Question Category - Product Design, Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 50

Question 1
How would you eliminate the need for patients to carry files between hospitals?
Approach for Question 1
Was focused on each step and was asking specific questions-
1. How would you do market research - Primary and secondary research
2. What are the challenges you expect - Getting different stakeholders buy-in including government, Standardization of data, Capital required
3. What would be the overarching approach- Mentioned both Public and Private but chose a partnership with government
4. How would I convince the government- Spoke about what needs to go into a pitch, POC approach as well?

Question 2
Team leadership and behavioural- How would I track performance of team, how would I measure it, what are my personal weaknesses that could hamper how I would lead a team, was given 2 minutes to pitch why they should hire me.
Approach for Question 2
Drew on work experience and answered.

Round 3
Question Category - Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 20

Question 1
HR interview - basic questions like intro, how to manage a team, why Providence and why healthcare, what is my leadership style, did I win anything at ISB and how did I choose a team member for the same.
Approach for Question 1
I gave the prepared answers, the purpose of the interview was to know me better and not to eliminate someone.

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?
Interviewers tried to make me feel comfortable. It was okay if I was not able to answer exactly what they had in mind. They are just checking your overall thought process. Very good process.

Rupeek

Company - Rupeek

Role - Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Type of Pre-assessment round - Case Submission

Details of the pre-assessment round
As a Growth and Monetisation PM at a fitness start-up, how would you come up with a plan to kick start growth and monetise a product (defined in the case)

Number of rounds - 2

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design, GTM/Market Entry, Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 60

Question 1
Explain your case submission and why did you choose to target a particular user segment

Question 2
You are a PM at Finshots. Come up with a monetisation plan for the product.
Approach for Question 2
Briefly walk through the 5Cs of the industry, and drill down on areas that the interviewer is interested in. Post that, apply the 4Ps framework and suggest a couple of monetisation plans.

Question 3
Why PM?
Approach for Question 3
Focus on your strengths and goals, and tailor the answer to the company a little bit.

Round 2
Question Category - Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 30

Question 1
This was an HR round with behavioural questions on my resume, past work experience, and why Rupeek.

Approach for Question 1

Prepare answers to standard questions in advance and appear confident

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?

The case study was important, and the interviewer asked me to defend the entire case study in front of them.

Company - Rupeek

Role - Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Number of rounds - 2

Round 1
Question Category - Guesstimate, GTM/Market Entry

Duration (in mins) - 40

Question 1
How many Swiggy delivery partners are present in Bangalore?
Approach for Question 1
I started with some clarifying questions like what delivery partners means, when we say Bangalore, what area we are talking about, etc. Then went onto dividing the area between urban and rural. Then it became a straightforward guesstimate question.

Question 2
How will you launch Zomato in a tier-2 city? What will be the launch metrics?
Approach for Question 2
After a lot of clarifying questions, I went on to divide the task into 3 subtasks: customer, delivery partners and restaurants. Then I used the new product launch structure for each of them. I also had to define launch metrics for each segment and choose 1st week, 1 month, 3 month and 6-month metric.

Question 3
Some questions for understanding culture fit, personality traits were also asked.

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?
It was a very smooth process. There were two panellists. They started with discussion about the case study that was given as a pre-assessment. Then we played an ice breaker game and went on to ask different questions. The panellists were giving me time to think and were listening to my answers carefully. Overall, it was a very good and productive discussion.

ShareChat

Company - ShareChat

Role - Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Number of rounds - 5

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design

Duration (in mins) - 105

Question 1
Create a product to improve the health of your users.
Approach for Question 1
Created a remote caring application that could be synced with any health check device like a smartwatch or fitness band to ensure distance caring and reporting is possible for any elderly.

Question 2
Design a fitness channel product addition for Netflix.
Approach for Question 2
Using Netflix's recommendation system, creating a fitness channel specially for kids who, after COVID, has been mostly playing games online - bringing physical activities home for kids using existing videos and movies.

Question 3
Design a product for Facebook Travel.
Approach for Question 3
Using Facebook's current data, creating a product to solve for trip planning and trip experience using Facebook groups with an objective to save time and remove contradictions in trip planning.

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?
Absolutely smooth. No overlaps, in-depth interviews, detailed feedback.

Swiggy

Company - Swiggy

Role - Associate Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Type of Pre-assessment round - Case Submission

Details of the pre-assessment round
Case study with 3 questions- same as last year

Number of rounds - 2

Round 1
Question Category - RCA, Metrics, GTM/Market Entry, Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 60

Question 1
Platform traffic on Swiggy has dropped suddenly and significantly last week. Do RCA.
Approach for Question 1
Break down into external and internal factors Eliminate external factors because the drop is sudden. Break down internal factors using the funnel. Dive into customer journey.

Question 2
How to improve Swiggy?
Approach for Question 2
Explored the social dimensions of Swiggy.

Question 3
Continuation of Q2- How to roll out one of the suggested features to the market How to measure success? Who would be the early adopter for the new rolled out feature?
Approach for Question 3
Discussed various experimental methods along with pros and cons -Identified metrics

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?
Be very thorough with company research as all questions asked were app specific.

Company - Swiggy

Role - Associate Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Type of Pre-assessment round - Case Submission

Details of the pre-assessment round
We had to choose between 3 cases (Swiggy Junior, Home Cooks, and Loyalty Program) to build on in terms of opportunity evaluation, creating a business case, key product propositions & differentiators, and the GTM launch plan. I'd chosen Home Cooks and my presentation included an analysis on market attractiveness (size, growth), goals & metrics, breaking down user personas and selecting which one to target, pain points, product proposition (with wireframe ideas - I'd made this on my iPad, didn't use any software), and a simple GTM plan. What I personally think candidates should do to stand out in this round is to come up with deeply thought through and unique ideas of how this can be implemented -- more than making the fanciest presentation or getting the perfect market sizing numbers.

Number of rounds - 2

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design, Guesstimate

Duration (in mins) - 45

Question 1
Guesstimate the market size for an EV-expert battery manufacturing company entering India.
Approach for Question 1
I narrowed down the scope to estimate the number of 4-wheelers in India to judge market attractiveness for the battery manufacturer (it could have otherwise included 2-wheelers, commercial vehicles, etc). Then I followed the standard process -- break the Indian population into urban/rural and the high/middle/low-income classes and took an estimate of the number of vehicles each segment owns. The interviewer refined my numbers wherever he wanted some changes (like excluding the low-income segment altogether for EV). Lastly, assumed the life of a vehicle to be 10 years to get the annual market size. Interviewer liked my approach and did not raise any concerns.

Question 2
How can we measure/change the discount perception on Instamart?
Approach for Question 2
Interviewer explained that Swiggy wanted to understand the discount perception of Instamart as compared to a competitor like BigBasket, and whether customers believed Instamart had higher/lower discounts as BB. I broke my answer down into 2 ways to dig deeper into this:

through customer surveys and through marketing/engagement activities. Interviewer tried to go deeper into both buckets, so he asked me which questions I would include in the survey and how would I measure this through marketing activities. My answers for the survey were a conjoint-like survey comparing IM and BB and a focus group discussion to understand what customers think about IM, do they order from competitors, etc. For marketing, my suggestion was to test discount-related notifications, ads against normal ones and see what's attracting more customers and getting more order value for Swiggy.

Round 2

Question Category - Technical

Duration (in mins) - 30

Question 1

Questions were mostly around the product work I'd done at my previous organisation.

Approach for Question 1

Interviewer asked me technical and behavioural questions around my PM project at a start-up. Questions included things like how I designed the flow, how did I communicate with the engineering team, etc. He also simulated different scenarios and asked me to problem solve on how I would change the program I'd built to factor in those changes.

Company - Swiggy

Role - Associate Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Number of rounds - 2

Round 1
Question Category - RCA

Duration (in mins) - 60

Question 1
Tell me about yourself and walk me through your case & thought process behind each decision.
Approach for Question 1
I broke down each slide and my reasoning behind each decision. The interviewer asked me a few questions regarding the metrics that I chose and how they connect back to the success of the product. I was then given a few minutes to come up with a few more metrics that I had missed.

Question 2
Root cause analysis, again based on my case submission. "Suppose your product is launched and after a month instead of onboarding 100k users out of 1 million, we've managed to only onboard 50K. Why?"
Approach for Question 2
I responded with a typical RCA approach, first with scoping and then following the user journey to identify the cause. In the end, the Root cause was a key element that I had overlooked in my submission.

Round 2
Question Category - Product Design, Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 90

Question 1
You work at a Kids furniture shop. How would you design a bookshelf for kids? Tell me your target audience, the design and metrics that you want to track.
Approach for Question 1
I identified the pain points of parents and the kids, picked a target audience and designed a solution keeping these in mind. For the metrics I split this into online and offline distribution and listed down a few metrics to track whether we're getting the intended results,

Question 2
Why Swiggy?

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?
The interview was very conversational. Most of the cases and questions asked required me to identify customers on two sides of the solution. E.g., parents and kids, restaurants and customers, etc. Swiggy typically has 4 rounds but had only 2 possibly due to time constraints.

Ula

Company - Ula

Role - Associate Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Type of Pre-assessment round - Case Submission

Details of the pre-assessment round
We had a case submission and 3 personal interviews. The 1st interview was based on the case and questions regarding the solution provided. The 2nd round was about my previous work experience and behavioural questions. The last round was with the HR where they asked behavioural questions.

Number of rounds - 3

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design

Duration (in mins) - 30

Question 1
Case based: Design an app for tracking delivery partners of Ula.
Approach for Question 1
This round was a case submission.
I started by mentioning all the assumptions about the case. Then followed the structure below:
1. chalked out the current tasks and current user behaviour
2. Defined the user persona
3. Defined the users' goals, the pain-points at each step and the solutions
4. Deep dive into the solutions with wireframes
5. Prioritisation + metrics
6. Launch plan
In the interview they asked me to explain the design idea and posed questions regarding my solutions. For example, is there a better way to solve for delivery tracking.

VMWare

Company - VMware

Role - EUC Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Number of rounds - 3

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design, Metrics

Duration (in mins) - 60

Question 1
Walk us through your resume.
Approach for Question 1
This is a basic question. Be prepared with a crisp answer rather than repeating the resume points and guide them to points you want to talk about.

Question 2
What is your favourite product and why?
Approach for Question 2
Again, another basic product question. It is best if you keep 3-4 favourite products ready for this kind of question. Also, the why should follow some framework, to provide structure and clarity on your thought process. Makes it easier for the interviewers to understand. Lot of frameworks are available online, choose whichever works for you and your fav product.

Question 3
How would you improve <favourite product from Q2>?

Round 2
Question Category - Metrics, GTM/Market Entry, Guesstimate

Duration (in mins) - 60

Question 1
Tell me about yourself.

Question 2
Product Mini-Case question. You are a PM of a company who wants to create a product for households in India. How would you go about it?
Approach for Question 2

It is a pretty open-ended question, so there are a lot of avenues to ask the right questions and clarify as quickly as possible. A lot of cross-questioning on key decisions taken by me on the pricing strategy, GTM strategy, guesstimates on number of households, target customers, etc.

Walmart

Company - Walmart

Role - Associate Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Number of rounds - 3

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design

Duration (in mins) - 45

Question 1
Design an app for the 16 - 25 years age group in the investment banking space.
Approach for Question 1
Designed an app for this age group to inculcate savings habit. Show all different investment options and help them decide on one and start saving.

Question 2
Why PM?

Question 3
Tell me about yourself.

Round 2
Question Category - Product Design, RCA

Duration (in mins) - 45

Question 1
Design a smart refrigerator.
Approach for Question 1
Took working professionals in an urban area as user persona and designed a fridge for their problems.

Question 2
Tell me everything you know about Walmart? Why PM? What challenges do you think a PM would face in Walmart? Walmart customers are not in India. How will you understand their pain points?

Question 3

RCA question - Walmart sales for PS5 reduced after Christmas on the app. Why?

Approach for Question 3

Logistics and delivery time breaches were happening continuously. Ppl want their gifts to be delivered on time. So, sales dropped.

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?

Recruiters were very knowledgeable, polite and guided throughout the process. It's best to be genuinely interested in the problem statement and talk then through your thought process

Company - Walmart

Role - APM

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Number of rounds - 3

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design

Duration (in mins) - 60

Question 1
How did you improve Sarovar? How did you identify issues and how did you go about solving them? How did you prioritise? I was the OSC director and hence was asked this question.
Approach for Question 1
Identification of issues was done through a feedback system. Improvements were done through sample feedback again. Prioritisation was done through an urgent/important framework.

Question 2
Why PM?

Round 2
Question Category - Product Design **Duration (in mins)** 60

Question 1
Improve Google maps to monetize it and show wireframes.
Approach for Question 1
Figured out different stakeholders/users of Google maps. These included cab drivers, public transportation drivers, goods transportation drivers, ambulances, food delivery executives, etc.
Wrote down use cases for all stakeholders and prioritised transportation drivers and food delivery executives based on scale and monetization potential.
Used their needs to come up with different solutions (providing terrain Data to show best road to reduce machine maintenance costs, providing real time prediction of food orders and their average delivery time to pre-order items). Gave a lot more solutions till the interviewer was satisfied. Also brought in public transportation systems. How to increase footfall and buses and optimise pickup location and time based on density.
Prioritised transportation systems because of scale. Drew basic wireframes on tab and showed on camera.

Round 3

Question Category - Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 60

Question 1

Asked about my past experience and why I wanted to be PM. It was a pure HR round and went deep into work ex while questioning each line on the resume.

Approach for Question 1

Explained resume in detail. Be prepared carefully with details on anything you've written in the resume.

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?

Process was smooth for the company. The interviewers were quite supportive and helped find different outs when I was stuck. They were stressful since 1-hour interviews can be brutal if you're stuck and can't seem to get the right answer, but the key is to take a step back, relax and then answer. They don't mind giving you a 2-3 mins break if you need it.

Company - Walmart

Role - Associate Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Number of rounds - 3

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design

Duration (in mins) - 45

Question 1
Design a smart fridge - in the second round.
Approach for Question 1
Took the CIRCLES approach. Asked clarifying questions on who the target audience should be etc. Was guided throughout the process of designing the fridge. The interviewer asked me the reason behind every assumption I made.

Question 2
Final round was with the head of product management. Main questions revolved around what I knew about Walmart, how do you retrieve information from consumers in the US while working from India, anticipated challenges, RCA questions around delayed delivery timelines.
Approach for Question 2
I had done a lot of research around Walmart, so that helped. Be spontaneous and give thoughtful answers.

Any self-reflection or advice specific to this company?
Just be calm and composed.
In my opinion, they are looking for creativity and out-of-the-box thinking. Do enough research about the company - history, what initiatives they are taking in emerging tech fields, how are they competing with major players, what kind of challenges they are facing, etc.

Zeta

Company - Zeta

Role - Associate Product manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Type of Pre-assessment round - Case Submission

Details of the pre-assessment round
Question was about a new start-up that has just been funded and is on a mission to digitise and transform the way retailers engage with their customers. We need to provide a product solution for the same

Number of rounds - 3

Round 1
Question Category - Product Design, RCA, GTM/Market Entry

Duration (in mins) - 50

Question 1
RCA- The inactive accounts have increased for the OTT platform, why?
Approach for Question 1
I started with clarifying questions and then approached internal and external factors. The reason was that the OTT platform (Hotstar) has lost the agreement to telecast IPL this year and hence people have moved to another platform.

Question 2
This was the follow up to the above question- Assume you are the PM at Hotstar, how will you approach this problem to increase viewership or decrease inactive users. Keeping the constraint that you can't get the IPL contract.
Approach for Question 2
Used the product design framework

Round 2
Question Category - Product Design

Duration (in mins) - 50

Question 1

Design sunglasses for kids.

Approach for Question 1

Clarified the question in depth, post clarification the interviewer asked me to design for 2–3-year-old.

Interviewer Feedback

Post the question, we have generic discussion about the company zeta and few of the products, the discussion went for 20 mins

Company - Zeta

Role - Associate Product Manager

Did you get an offer from the company - Yes

Type of Pre-assessment round - Case Submission

Details of the pre-assessment round
COVID has taken a hit on local businesses, and there now exists a gap between consumers and their local shops. Design an app and a strategy to help connect local shop owners with customers.
I solved this by creating an app like Dunzo, listing local shops and allowing customers to add items to their basket. I also created additional views to help shop owners manage inventory, reach out to the right customers and more.

Number of rounds - 2

Round 1
Question Category - Metrics, GTM/Market Entry, Technical, Behavioural

Duration (in mins) - 30

Question 1
General discussion on the case comp submission - additional questions on metrics we would track and the technical difficulty of implementing a solution like the one proposed.
Approach for Question 1
I made sure to keep it conversational throughout and ask for the interviewer's thoughts on different parts of my case submission. For example, I had recommended an integration with Society Management apps like My gate and used this as a discussion pointer with the interviewer, asking her how we could go about that process and how likely it was to happen.

Round 2
Question Category - Product Design, Metrics, Technical

Duration (in mins) - 40

Question 1
Name a product that I personally use regularly, and a possible feature that would help one of my pain points with the app.
Approach for Question 1
I already had ideated a few features for apps that I use regularly and used one of them for this discussion. However, I couldn't use personas in this case as it was an issue that I personally faced

with the app. Hence, while discussing the problem statement I started with personal problems that I face with the app and focused a bit on that. Once the problem area was described, I went on to how the feature would help me personally.

Question 2

For the feature described, what metrics would I track as a PM and why?

Approach for Question 2

Standard metrics question, that I broke down into north star metric and secondary metrics to track. There were further questions around how these would be captured and other ways to track this info, where I spoke about user surveys, etc.

Additional Resources

Here is a list of previous years' handbooks if you want additional assistance. We have also included the Consulting Handbooks since some aspects of interviews, such as market entry or guesstimates, are more exhaustively covered there.

BTC Handbooks
BTC Handbook, Class of 2022
BTC Handbook, Class of 2021
BTC Handbook, Class of 2020
BTC Handbook, Class of 2019
BTC Handbook, Class of 2018

Consulting Handbooks
Consulting Handbook, Class of 2022
Consulting Handbook, Class of 2021

As of Class of 2023, there are no Marketing or Analytics Handbooks. But, do speak to the Marketing Club regarding GTM/Launch questions and the Business Analytics Club regarding Metrics questions if you want additional guidance.

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